BENCHMARKING DEEP LEARNING FRAMEWORKS FOR INDIVIDUAL TREE SEGMENTATION AND SPECIES CLASSIFICATION IN TEMPERATE FORESTS

by

GEORGE ROHAN POTTAMKULAM



universität freiburg

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Faculty of Environment and Natural Resources
University of Freiburg
Freiburg im Breisgau, Germany

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Abstract

Individual-tree inventories remain labour-intensive. Deep learning on terrestrial laser scanning (TLS) can automate tree delineation (instance segmentation) and species classification, but published benchmarks already show large performance gaps across forest types. This study evaluates both tasks on temperate mixed TLS scenes, with emphasis on where structural context still drives misses.

Manually refined TLS instance references were built for two University of Freiburg research forests in southwestern Germany: a beech-dominated Ettenheim plot (approximately 50 m × 50 m; 128 ground-truth trees) and a denser spruce-dominated Mathislewald subplot (approximately 25 m × 25 m; 189 ground-truth trees). Two instance-segmentation models, ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree, were scored against that reference with point-count IoU matching. Field-inventory stems were linked only to the manual trees. The species-classification model DetailView was then applied to those matched stems under four instance sources: manual, SegmentAnyTree, ForestMamba, and ForestMamba+BluePoint (BluePoint re-runs ForestMamba on points left unclassified after the first pass to recover missed clusters).

At plot level (F1 at IoU threshold 0.5), ForestMamba ranked ahead on both sites (70.3% at Ettenheim; 37.0% at Mathislewald). SegmentAnyTree was competitive at Ettenheim (64.2%) but much weaker at Mathislewald (14.5%). These rankings use a reference edited from preliminary ForestMamba instances. Per-tree hard F1 (the point-overlap F1 of each ground-truth tree at IoU 0.5; zero if unmatched) showed two failure regimes: at Ettenheim, crowding mattered most, with crowded trees about 22 percentage points lower in ForestMamba hard F1 and 45 points lower in SegmentAnyTree hard F1 than the most open third of trees; at Mathislewald, height and whole-tree size dominated, and both models missed most small, low-volume trees (near 0-4% hard F1 in the lowest size thirds).

On inventory-matched stems, DetailView overall accuracy with manual instances was 46.8% at Ettenheim ($N = 111$) and 62.5% at Mathislewald ($N = 32$; small sample). Species errors came mainly from open-set taxonomic transfer and class imbalance; delineation quality was secondary. Neighbourhood openness did not clearly improve species accuracy, and large whole-tree volume at Ettenheim tracked poorer labels mainly because those stems were mostly beech. Switching to automatic instances changed Ettenheim stem-level accuracy by only a few percentage points, and by noisier amounts at Mathislewald; that contrast scores species labels on already-matched stems (classification given instances), leaving full end-to-end species-map accuracy for later work.

This work documents a reproducible local reference protocol. Better instances or packing-based QA filters are unlikely, on their own, to close the taxonomic gap without local model adaptation.

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List of abbreviations

Abbreviations and short forms used in this work are defined below. Model and product names that are written in full throughout (for example ForestMamba, SegmentAnyTree and DetailView) are omitted; BluePoint is listed because it is a processing step rather than a stand-alone model name.

- **ALS**: Airborne laser scanning
- **BluePoint**: ForestMamba post-refinement on first-pass unclassified points
- **CCB2**: Modern CloudCompare binary project format
- **CI**: Confidence interval
- **CRS**: Coordinate reference system
- **DBH**: Diameter at breast height
- **ECOSENSE**: Ecosystem sensing research infrastructure / forest at Ettenheim
- **EPSG**: Coordinate reference system code registry (here EPSG:32632, UTM zone 32N)
- **F1**: Harmonic mean of precision and recall
- **FN**: False negative (unmatched ground-truth tree at the IoU gate)
- **FOR-species20K**: Large-scale forest tree-species classification benchmark used by DetailView
- **FP**: False positive (unmatched predicted instance at the IoU gate)
- **GT**: Ground truth (manual instance reference)
- **Hull volume**: Whole-tree convex-hull volume (3D convex hull of all retained points of a manual tree)
- **IoU**: Intersection over Union (point-count overlap used for instance matching)
- **LAZ**: Compressed ASPRS LAS point-cloud file format
- **MLS**: Mobile laser scanning
- N: Sample size (trees or stems in the stated set)
- N_{GT}: Number of ground-truth tree instances
- N_{pred}: Number of predicted tree instances
- **NN**: Nearest neighbour (planimetric distance between whole-tree centroids of manual ground-truth trees)
- **OA**: Overall accuracy

- **PredInstance**: Stem / instance identifier field used for DetailView packages
- **QA**: Quality assurance
- ρ: Spearman rank correlation coefficient
- τ: IoU matching threshold
- **TLS**: Terrestrial laser scanning
- **TP**: True positive (accepted ground-truth-prediction match)
- **ULS**: Unmanned / UAV laser scanning
- X_{eval}: Shared evaluation point set used for instance scoring
- **XYZ**: Cartesian spatial coordinates

1 Introduction

Stem-level inventories that record species, size and condition still feed biomass, habitat and yield work, but collecting them in the field remains expensive and hard to densify where access or labour is limited (Bundesministerium für Ernährung und Landwirtschaft (BMEL), 2021; Smith, 2002).

Terrestrial laser scanning (TLS) with deep learning can recover individual stems and species labels from dense ground-based clouds (Calders et al., 2020; Kattenborn et al., 2021; Liang et al., 2016), but published TLS instance benchmarks already show large spreads across methods and forest conditions (Cherlet et al., 2026), and off-the-shelf species models still struggle under taxonomic transfer and class imbalance (Fassnacht et al., 2016; Puliti et al., 2025). Paired inventory and manually refined TLS instances on local temperate plots remain scarce for measuring both failures under one protocol.

This research builds manually refined TLS references for two university research forests in southwestern Germany and benchmarks current deep-learning workflows for individual-tree analysis on them. Recent TLS instance-segmentation benchmarks already report large spreads across methods and forest conditions (Cherlet et al., 2026). The three research questions below narrow that programme to recovery under a shared protocol, structural covariates of error, and how automatic instance sources shift stem-level species labels relative to a manual baseline.

1.1 Research questions

1. How accurately do ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree recover manually verified individual trees in complex temperate TLS scenes, and how does DetailView perform on inventory-matched stems under manual instances?

2. How does performance vary with tree height (z_{99}-z_{05}), whole-tree convex-hull volume, and neighbourhood (planimetric nearest-neighbour distance among whole-tree centroids)?

3. To what extent do automatic instance sources change stem-level species labels relative to the manual-instance baseline on the same inventory-matched trees?

1.2 Aims

1. Build manually refined TLS instance references for the two study sites, linked to field inventory where available.

2. Benchmark ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree for tree delineation, and DetailView for species classification on inventory-matched stems.

3. Relate per-tree segmentation and species performance to tree height, whole-tree size, and neighbourhood crowding.

4. Measure how switching from manual to automatic instances changes DetailView species labels on the same matched stems.

2 Related work

2.1 Individual-tree instance segmentation

Individual-tree detection began mainly with airborne laser scanning (ALS) crown products (Hyyppä et al., 2008; Wang et al., 2016) and now also uses dense proximal clouds from terrestrial, mobile and unmanned platforms (Liang et al., 2016; Newnham et al., 2015; Wilkes et al., 2017). Classical TLS pipelines grow stems and crowns with region growing, topology or quantitative structure models (QSMs) that reconstruct branching architecture from dense ground-based clouds (Burt et al., 2019; Raumonen et al., 2013).

Deep learning methods now perform end-to-end instance and panoptic segmentation on LiDAR clouds. SegmentAnyTree transfers across ULS, TLS and MLS (Wielgosz et al., 2024); ForAINet joins semantic and instance heads for inventory attributes on dense airborne data (Xiang et al., 2024); and ForestFormer3D combines semantic and instance segmentation with standard detection metrics on expanded FOR-instance benchmarks (Puliti et al., 2023; Xiang et al., 2025). ForestMamba uses sparse Mamba queries for forest scenes (Nguyen et al., 2026). TreeLearn reports that, with good labels, learned instance segmentation on ground-based clouds can match or beat classical pipelines (Henrich et al., 2024). Broader TLS benchmarks show large gaps across methods and sites and call for clear reference protocols (Cherlet et al., 2026).

2.2 Tree species classification from proximal LiDAR

Species mapping from remote sensing has a long optical and multi-sensor literature (Fassnacht et al., 2016; Pu, 2021), and on single-tree point clouds the field has moved from hand-crafted features to deep multi-view and point-based networks. FOR-species20K set an open baseline across 33 species and TLS/MLS/ULS; DetailView (multi-view DenseNet) led the competition (Puliti et al., 2025). In practice many classifiers assume clean manual instances, and automatic segmentation can lower species accuracy (Puliti et al., 2025).

2.3 Structural attributes, biomass and inventory linkage

After delineation, TLS supports plot-scale measures such as height, DBH and crown geometry (Kükenbrink et al., 2022; Liu et al., 2018). QSMs and related reconstructions allow nondestructive biomass estimates that can outperform allometry alone in some settings (Calders et al., 2015; Disney et al., 2018). National inventory protocols remain the taxonomic and sampling reference for remote-sensing products (Bundesministerium für Ernährung und Landwirtschaft (BMEL), 2021).

2.4 Reference data and evaluation gaps

National inventory protocols define field practice (Bundesministerium für Ernährung und Landwirtschaft (BMEL), 2021), yet TLS deep-learning studies often use small or poorly documented labels (Cherlet et al., 2026; Hamedianfar et al., 2022). FOR-instance and related benchmarks improve segmentation comparability (Puliti et al., 2023; Xiang et al., 2025). Cherlet et al. already show that instance accuracy varies strongly with forest conditions (Cherlet et al., 2026).

This study adds paired inventory and manually refined TLS instances on two temperate mixed university forests as local testbeds for those remaining evaluation gaps.

3 Study sites and data

3.1 Study sites

Two temperate research forests in Baden-Württemberg, southwestern Germany, supply the data. They share inventory and TLS over the same footprints and were chosen for that paired coverage; the pair also contrasts a lower, milder beech-dominated plot with a higher, denser spruce-dominated subplot.

3.1.1 Ettenheim (ECOSENSE)

Ettenheim sits in the western foothills of the Black Forest, on the eastern edge of the Upper Rhine Plain near the town of Ettenheim (approximately 48.2680°N, 7.8782°E). Elevation is comparatively low for the Black Forest, and the climate is milder and warmer than the uplands to the southeast.

The analysed plot is about 50 m × 50 m (2500 m^2) and holds 115 inventoried stems. European beech (*Fagus sylvatica*) dominates at 71.3% of stems, followed by silver fir (*Abies alba*, 15.7%) and Douglas fir (*Pseudotsuga menziesii*, 11.3%). Norway spruce (*Picea abies*) and European larch (*Larix decidua*) are each below 1%.

The plot belongs to the University of Freiburg ECOSENSE forest site, which develops sensor networks for climate-stressed forests and combines close-range remote sensing, vertical optical-depth measurements, drone laser scanning and satellite time series (Chair of Sensor-based Geoinformatics, University of Freiburg, 2026; ECOSENSE - SFB 1537, University of Freiburg, 2026). The wider ECOSENSE forest is a beech-dominated mix with patches of spruce, oak, fir, Douglas fir and pine; selected stands host eddy-covariance and canopy-access infrastructure (ECOSENSE - SFB 1537, University of Freiburg, 2026).

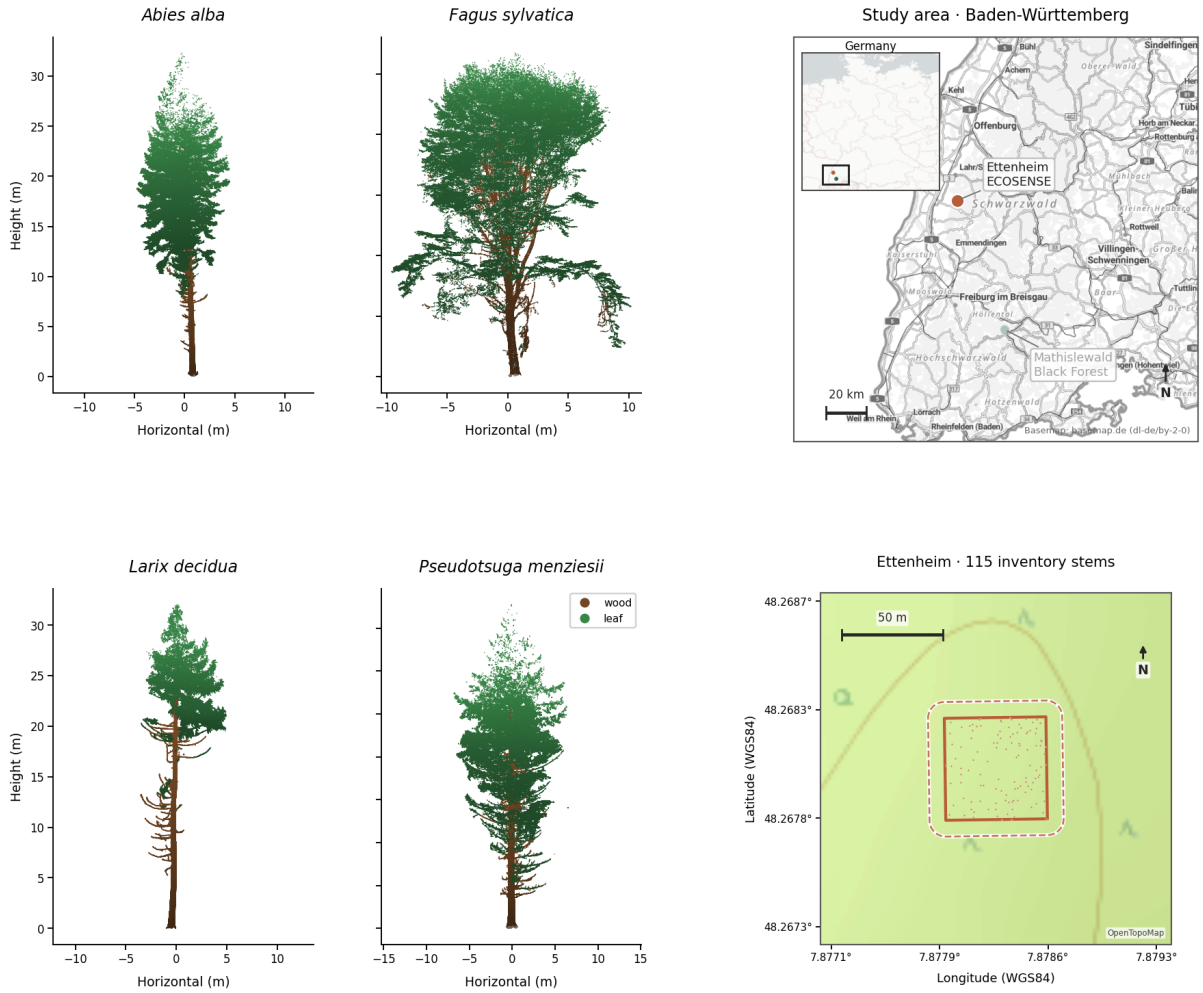


Figure 1: Ettenheim research plot. Left: colourised 2D side profiles of the largest inventory-matched tree of each species present in the plot (wood brown, foliage green). Right: location of the plot on a topographic map, with the approximate length and width of the research footprint indicated.

3.1.2 Mathislewald (Hinterzarten)

As the contrasting upland counterpart, Mathislewald sits in the southern Black Forest near Hinterzarten and Mathisleweiher (approximately 47.8847°N, 8.0885°E), substantially higher than Ettenheim, with a cooler, wetter montane climate.

Norway spruce (*Picea abies*) dominates at 64.7% of inventoried stems, followed by European beech (*Fagus sylvatica*, 23.5%) and silver fir (*Abies alba*, 11.8%). Footprint: about 25 m × 25 m (625 m^2); 34 inventoried stems.

The site is part of a 127 ha University of Freiburg research and teaching forest digitised with remote sensing as a pilot region for digital-twin and augmented-reality work (Professur für Waldwachstum und Dendroökologie, University of Freiburg, 2026; Wissen über den Wald im Wandel (WWW 4.0), University of Freiburg, 2026), and it links to WaldAgil's individual-tree digitisation aims with drones, laser scanning, AI-based tree recognition and AR interfaces for digital-twin scenario planning (WaldAgil, University of Freiburg, 2026a,b).

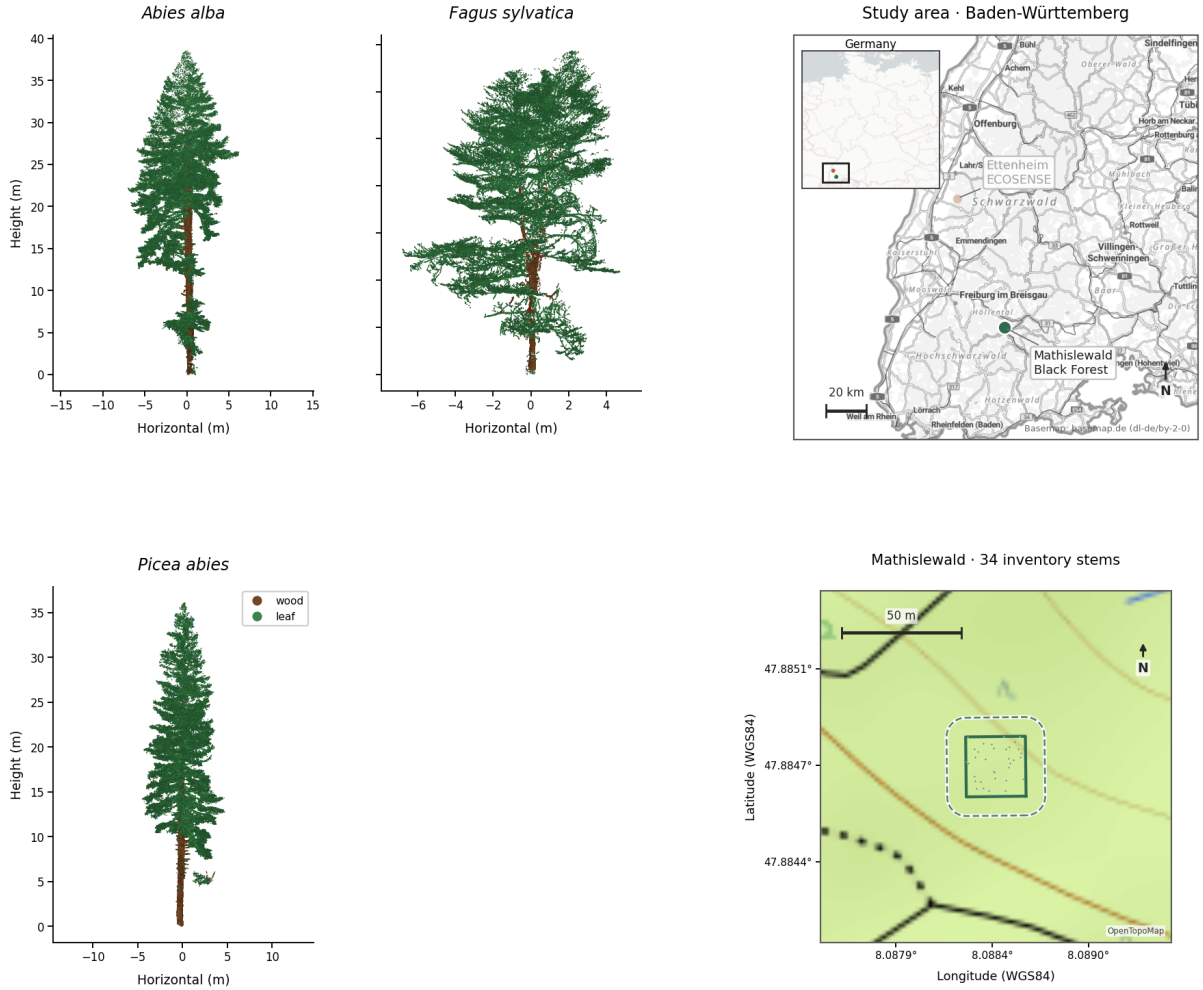


Figure 2: Mathislewald research plot. Left: colourised 2D side profiles of the largest inventory-matched tree of each species present in the plot (wood brown, foliage green). Right: location of the plot on a topographic map, with the approximate length and width of the research footprint indicated.

3.2 Data and models

Field inventory supplies species, DBH and related stem attributes used as taxonomic ground truth (Liang et al., 2016; Liu et al., 2018; Riedel and Kändler, 2017). All evaluated clouds are TLS so both sites share the same proximal geometric reference; drone laser scanning in the wider ECOSENSE and WaldAgil portfolios is out of scope here (Chair of Sensor-based Geoinformatics, University of Freiburg, 2026; WaldAgil, University of Freiburg, 2026a).

Instance segmentation uses SegmentAnyTree (Wielgosz et al., 2024) and ForestMamba (Nguyen et al., 2026); species classification uses DetailView (Puliti et al., 2025). Inventory labels are mapped to FOR-species20K taxonomy IDs; unmapped labels are dropped from species accuracy. Manual instance references were built in CloudCompare with stable instance identifiers so the same stems can be scored under different automatic instance sources.

In the tree-point reference packages, Ettenheim (50 m × 50 m) has about 20.5 million tree points ($\approx 8.2\,\mathrm{k\,m^{-2}}$), while Mathislewald (25 m × 25 m) has about 12.9 million ($\approx 20.7\,\mathrm{k\,m^{-2}}$). The denser Mathislewald cloud is why that site uses the smaller footprint.

4 Methodology

The sites already supply field inventory and TLS. The work that follows turns those products into a shared evaluation chain: clip each cloud to the inventoried stand, cut it into editable tiles, build a geometric tree reference by hand, score ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree against that reference, link inventory stems to manual trees for taxonomy, then run DetailView on the same stems under several instance sources. All geospatial steps use EPSG:32632.

4.1 From full TLS scenes to editable tiles

The delivered TLS scenes are larger than the inventoried stands. Inventory stem positions were enclosed with a concave hull, buffered by 10 m, and used to clip the cloud so later work stayed inside the area supported by both inventory and geometry. Hull tightness was adjusted per site until the boundary followed the stand without cutting valid inventory stems; every retained inventory point had to fall inside the clip. The retained cloud therefore surrounds the stand with a controlled margin (Figure 3).

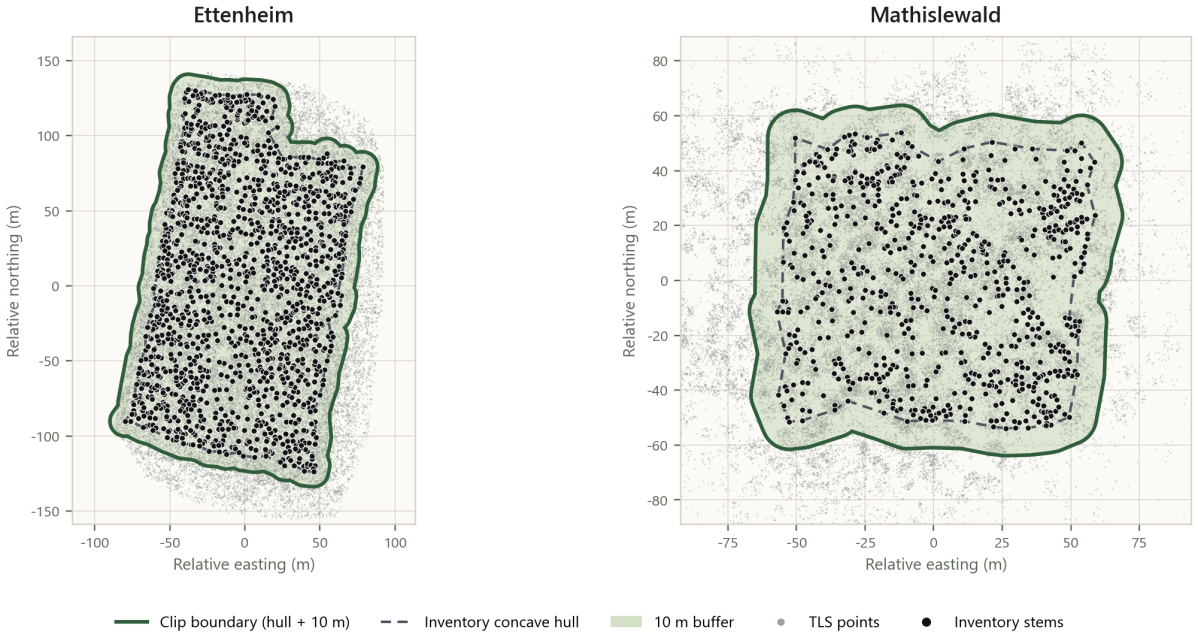


Figure 3: Inventory-guided TLS clipping for Ettenheim (left) and Mathislewald (right). Inventory stems, the inventory concave hull, the 10 m buffer and the resulting clip boundary are shown over a thinned top view of the TLS cloud.

Even clipped, the clouds are too large for interactive three-dimensional editing. Each scene was cut into 25 m × 25 m tiles centred on the clip. Only cells that intersected the clip were retained and numbered from the centre. Preliminary ForestMamba labels in the source clouds were used to export one layer per predicted tree, plus ground and catch-all material. Trees with any point within 0.12 m of the outer clip edge were dropped so incomplete edge crowns would not enter the reference.

Annotated tiles were Ettenheim `tile_001-tile_004` (about 50 m × 50 m) and Mathislewald `tile_001` (about 25 m × 25 m; Figure 4). Remaining tiles were archived but not manually edited.

Dense temperate TLS editing remains labour-intensive even with modern scanners (Liang et al., 2016; Wilkes et al., 2017).

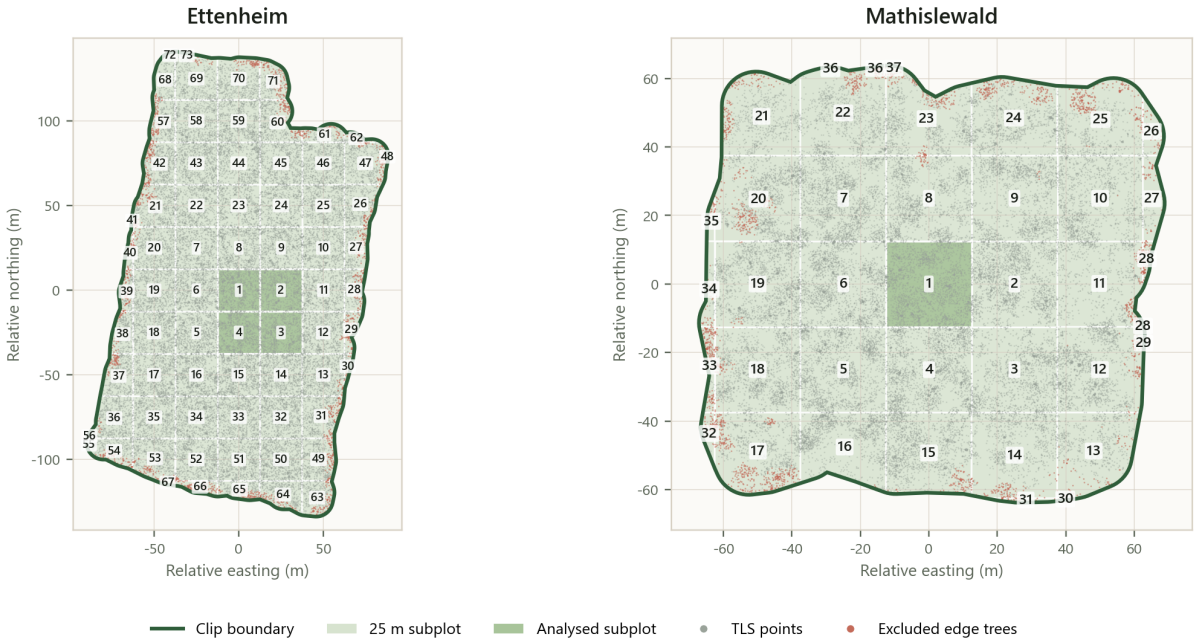


Figure 4: Twenty-five-metre subplot layouts for Ettenheim (left) and Mathislewald (right). Subplots are numbered in ring-clockwise order from the centre. Darker cells mark the manually analysed subplots, and coral points mark trees excluded for lying on the outer clip edge.

4.2 Building the geometric tree reference

For each analysed tile the exported layers were imported into CloudCompare. Starting from the preliminary ForestMamba instances, layers were split, merged and cleaned until each retained tree layer was one physical stem and crown. Ambiguous or non-tree material stayed in catch-all layers rather than being forced into a tree ID. Completed projects were spot-checked for mixed stems or incomplete crowns.

4.3 Scoring ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree

Automatic predictions were compared with the manual layers on a shared point set X_{eval}: every point in the analysed projects (trees, catch-alls and ground). The same XYZ locations were taken from ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree so each point carried a ground-truth ID and a predicted ID. Ground and non-tree material used ground-truth ID `-1`.

Matching followed the ForestFormer3D individual-tree style (Xiang et al., 2025). Point-count IoU was computed between each prediction and each ground-truth tree. Predictions with fewer than 100 points were dropped in the primary protocol; sensitivity also tested $n_{\min} \in \{0, 25, 50, 100, 200\}$. Remaining predictions were assigned by greedy one-to-one IoU maximisation, accepting a match only at IoU $\geq \tau = 0.5$. A Hungarian assignment on the same IoU matrix (still rejecting pairs below τ) was run as a check; primary tables keep greedy matching with $n_{\min} = 100$.

From those matches we report precision, recall, F1 and coverage (mean best IoU per ground-

truth tree, without the τ gate), plus TP/FP/FN counts. Secondary diagnostics flag over- and under-segmentation at IoU ≥ 0.25. Matching was repeated for $\tau \in \{0.3, 0.4, 0.5, 0.6, 0.7\}$ and per subplot. Plot-level F1 pools TP/FP/FN across the subplot. Separately, *per-tree hard F1* scores each ground-truth tree under the same greedy $\tau = 0.5$ assignment: matched trees get the pairwise point-count F1 with their partner; unmatched trees score zero. *Macro hard F1* is the unweighted mean over all N_{GT} trees, so misses pull the mean down. Soft per-tree F1 (best overlap without the exclusive τ gate) is only a secondary diagnostic.

To see which trees fail, hard F1 was related to three structural covariates from each manual tree cloud. *Height* is z_{99}-z_{05}. The *whole-tree planimetric centroid* is the mean (x, y) of all retained points of that tree. *Nearest-neighbour distance* is the planimetric gap from that centroid to the closest other ground-truth centroid. *Whole-tree convex-hull volume* is the 3D convex hull of all retained XYZ points of that tree. Fixed-radius neighbour counts and planimetric hull-overlap fractions were also checked on interior trees but did not clearly improve on nearest-neighbour distance once residualised on spacing, so reported packing associations keep nearest-neighbour distance. Inventory matching later uses breast-height centroids.

Associations used two-sided Spearman tests. Trees in a subplot are spatially dependent, so N trees are not N independent replicates. The battery is exploratory: effect sizes (tercile means and ρ) are emphasised, ρ and p are reported even when $p \geq 0.05$, and Benjamini-Hochberg q-values within site provide a multiplicity-aware sensitivity summary.

4.4 Linking inventory stems for species evaluation

Segmentation uses the full manual reference. Species evaluation needs a second link: which inventory stems correspond to which manual trees.

Before assignment, inventory stems and manual trees were overlaid in a breast-height plan view ($1.3\,\mathrm{m} \pm 0.05\,\mathrm{m}$ above a local ground surface fitted to labelled ground; Figure 5). Residual offsets that still identified the same tree were accepted. The inventory overlay was shifted from paired markers at Mathislewald and adjusted interactively at Ettenheim.

Inventory stems and manual layers were then paired one-to-one on that breast-height geometry. A pair was eligible only when

$$\mathrm{dist} \leq r_{\mathrm{inv}} + r_{\mathrm{layer}} + 0.75\,\mathrm{m}, \tag{1}$$

with r_{inv} the inventory breast-height radius and r_{layer} the radius of the layer's breast-height point envelope. Each stem and each layer could enter at most one pair. Near-ties were broken with an attribute cost on diameter ratio and relative height difference; short stubs were strongly penalised. A few visually confirmed but geometrically awkward pairs were added by hand; unsuitable layers were excluded from the matched set.

Unmatched inventory stems and unmatched manual layers were reviewed separately. Only exclusive inventory-manual pairs enter species classification, so species scores are conditional on successful registration and are not plot-wide accuracy on every tree.

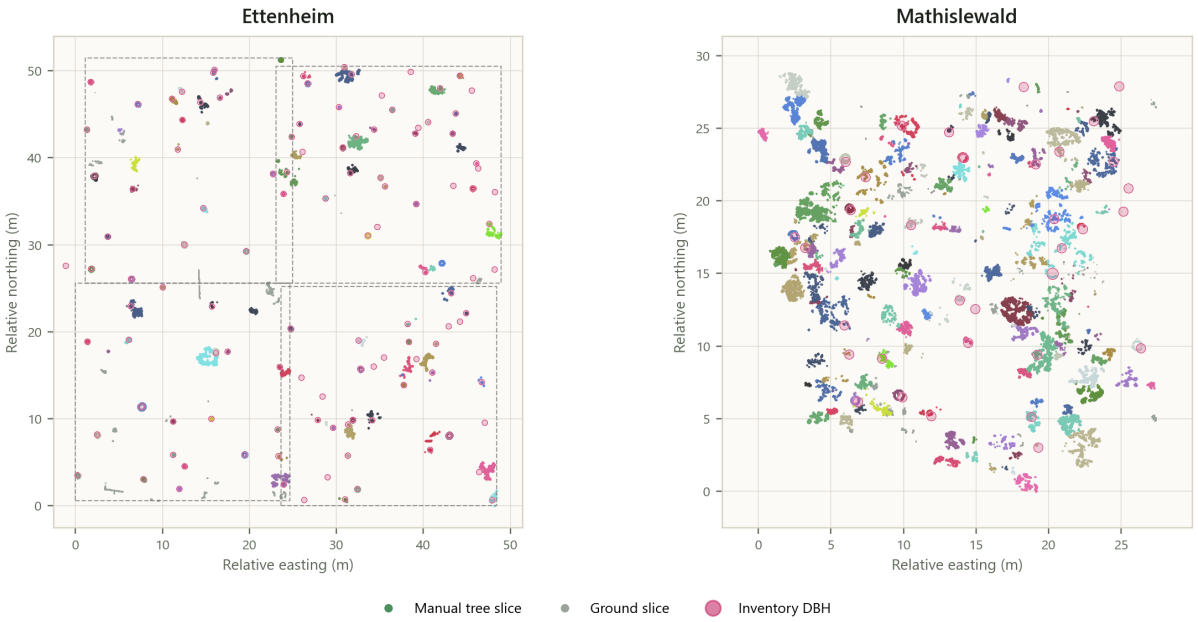


Figure 5: Breast-height plan views used to inspect co-registration of inventory and TLS at Ettenheim (left) and Mathislewald (right). Coloured points are manual tree layers in a $1.3\,\mathrm{m} \pm 0.05\,\mathrm{m}$ band along the local ground normal. Magenta rings mark inventory stem positions (radius proportional to recorded DBH, with a small minimum display size for readability). At Mathislewald the inventory circles incorporate the estimated translational shift.

4.5 Species classification across instance tracks

DetailView (Puliti et al., 2025) was run on the inventory-matched stems using the European model region. Point-wise species IDs and probabilities were returned, with probabilities averaged over 50 augmented forward passes per tree as in FOR-species20K. Restricting species scores to inventory-matched stems reflects that taxonomic products inherit both delineation quality and field-label completeness (Fassnacht et al., 2016; Puliti et al., 2025).

To isolate instance source, DetailView was run on the same matched stems under four tracks: manual, SegmentAnyTree, ForestMamba, and ForestMamba+BluePoint. BluePoint re-runs ForestMamba on points left unclassified after the first pass and merges newly found clusters with the first-pass instances. Trees missed by automatic segmentation outside the matched set do not enter the scores; the ablation measures classification given instances, not end-to-end species-map accuracy.

Each track was aggregated to the stem by the mode of non-nodata species IDs inside the instance. Inventory names were mapped to FOR-species20K taxonomy IDs; predictions outside the local mapped classes were treated as open-set.

Stem-level summaries used overall accuracy, balanced accuracy, and macro-averaged precision, recall and F1. Overall accuracy used percentile bootstrap intervals (1000 resamples). Gaps versus the manual track used paired bootstrap intervals on stem-wise ΔOA. The same structural covariates used for hard F1 were joined to the matched stems so species accuracy can be stratified on the same axes, again with exploratory Spearman tests and within-site Benjamini-Hochberg q-values.

5 Results

5.1 Observational overview of the prepared scenes

On the analysed footprints (Ettenheim `tile_001-tile_004`; Mathislewald `tile_001`; Methodology Figures 3 and 4), larger trees look broadly similar under the manual reference, ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree (Figure 6), while SegmentAnyTree shows more visible mistakes, especially among smaller trees (Figure 7).

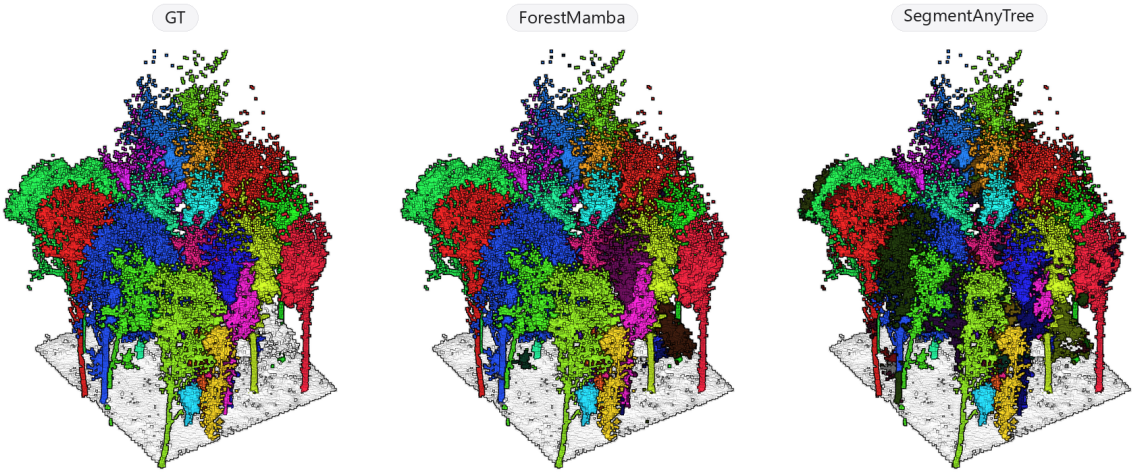


Figure 6: Ettenheim subplot `tile_001`: qualitative instance colouring for the manual reference, ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree.

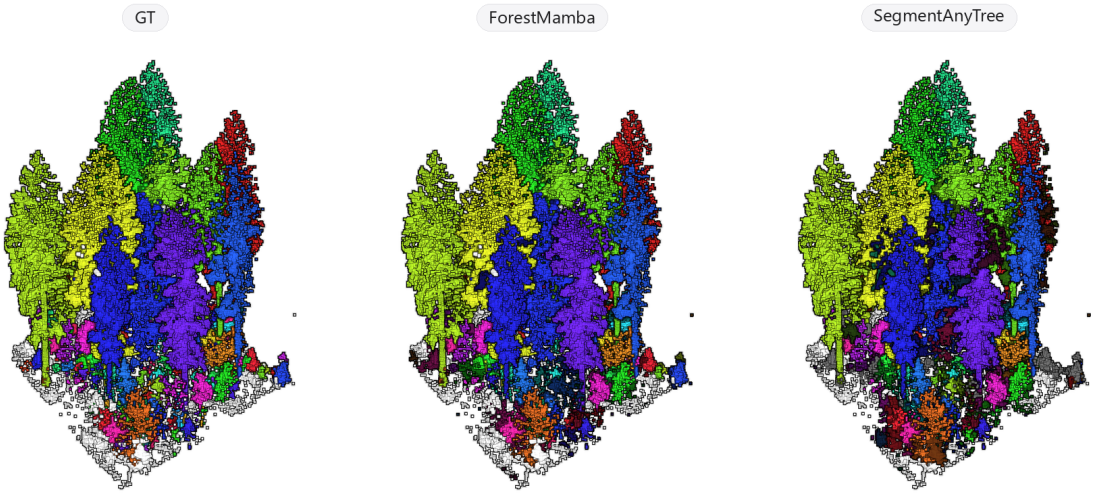


Figure 7: Mathislewald subplot `tile_001`: same layout as Figure 6 for the manual reference, ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree.

5.2 Manual reference scope

Per-subplot ground-truth tree counts at Ettenheim were 25, 41, 38 and 24 for `tile_001` to `tile_004`. At Mathislewald the single annotated subplot contributed 189 ground-truth trees (Table 1). These counts define the denominator for recall and related detection metrics below. They are distinct from the later inventory-matched stem counts used for species classification (Figure 8).

Table 1: Manual instance-reference scope used for segmentation evaluation (N_{GT} population in Figure 8).

Site	Subplots	N_{GT}	Tree points	Total X_{eval} points
Ettenheim	001-004	128	22 714 670	26 997 057
Mathislewald	001	189	14 605 364	24 260 295

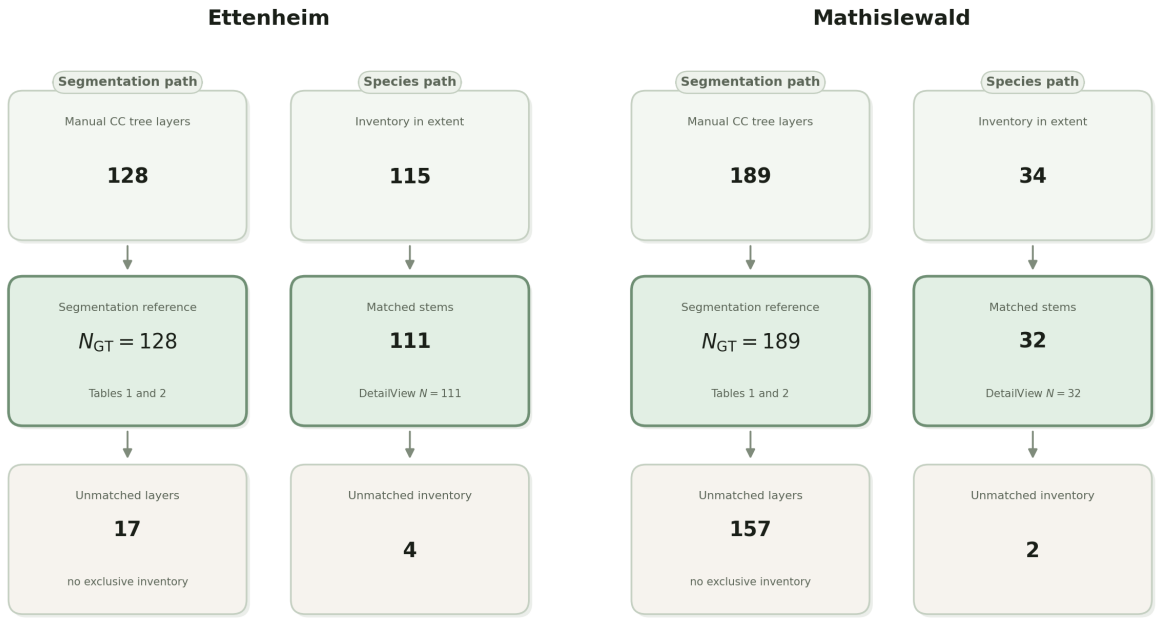


Figure 8: Evaluation populations on each site. The segmentation path uses every retained manual ground-truth tree as N_{GT} (Tables 1 and 2). The species path retains only exclusive inventory-matched stems (Table 6), which are the DetailView evaluation set. Unmatched layers lack an exclusive inventory partner, and unmatched inventory stems lack an exclusive manual layer.

5.3 Overall performance

5.3.1 Plot-level instance segmentation

A Hungarian assignment check on the same IoU matrices reproduced the greedy plot-level precision, recall, F1 and coverage to numerical identity on both sites and both models at $\tau = 0.5$. Varying the minimum predicted-instance size over $n_{min} \in \{0, 25, 50, 100, 200\}$ changed F1 by at most a few percentage points and did not alter model ranking or the Mathislewald SegmentAnyTree failure (F1 remained near 14-15% across thresholds). At the primary settings ($\tau = 0.5$, $n_{min} = 100$), Ettenheim F1 was 70.3% for ForestMamba and 64.2% for SegmentAnyTree; Mathislewald F1 was 37.0% and 14.5% (Figure 9; Table 2).

At Ettenheim, ForestMamba per-subplot F1 ranged from 63.0% on `tile_004` to 72.7% on `tile_001`; SegmentAnyTree ranged from 46.5% on `tile_003` to 65.4% on `tile_002` (Table 3).

Across $\tau \in \{0.3, 0.4, 0.5, 0.6, 0.7\}$, Ettenheim ForestMamba F1 moved from 70.9% at $\tau = 0.3$ to

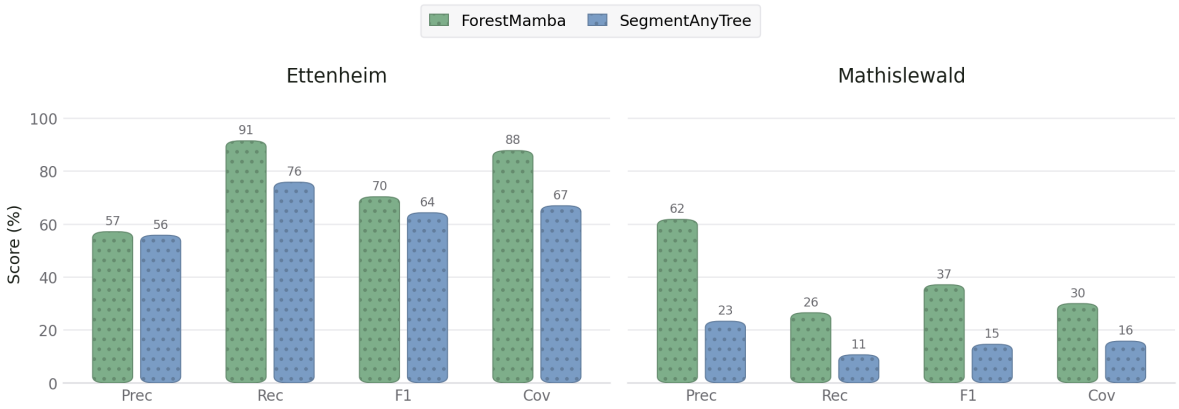


Figure 9: Plot-level instance-segmentation scores at IoU threshold $\tau = 0.5$ for ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree on Ettenheim and Mathislewald.

Table 2: Instance-segmentation metrics at $\tau = 0.5$ on the full manual reference (N_{GT}; Figure 8). Precision, recall, F1 and coverage are percentages.

Site	Method	Prec	Rec	F1	Cov	N_{pred}	TP	FP	FN
Ettenheim	ForestMamba	57.1	91.4	70.3	87.7	205	117	88	11
Ettenheim	SegmentAnyTree	55.7	75.8	64.2	66.9	174	97	77	31
Mathislewald	ForestMamba	61.7	26.5	37.0	29.9	81	50	31	139
Mathislewald	SegmentAnyTree	23.3	10.6	14.5	15.7	86	20	66	169

Table 3: Ettenheim per-subplot instance metrics at $\tau = 0.5$.

Subplot	N_{GT}	FM F1	FM Cov	SAT F1	SAT Cov	FM TP/FP/FN	SAT TP/FP/FN
001	25	72.7	94.3	59.5	76.8	24/17/1	22/27/3
002	41	71.8	88.4	65.4	71.9	37/25/4	34/29/7
003	38	69.5	80.3	46.5	52.9	33/24/5	23/38/15
004	24	63.0	91.4	56.3	76.1	23/26/1	20/27/4

70.3% at $\tau = 0.5$ and 66.1% at $\tau = 0.7$; SegmentAnyTree F1 moved from 68.9% to 64.2% to 50.3% (Figures A.2 and A.3). At Mathislewald, ForestMamba F1 moved from 46.7% to 37.0% to 23.7%, and SegmentAnyTree F1 from 26.2% to 14.5% to 7.3%.

At $\tau = 0.5$, ForestMamba recorded 11 missed trees and 10 leakage-flagged true positives at Ettenheim versus 31 and 42 for SegmentAnyTree; at Mathislewald the same counts were 139 and 18 versus 169 and 12 (Table 4). Appendix plan views at Mathislewald are dominated by false-negative ground-truth centroids for both models, with comparatively few true positives (Figures A.6 and A.7; IoU distributions in Figures A.4 and A.5). ForestMamba recovers more matched trees than SegmentAnyTree, but neither leaves a spatially localised miss pattern confined to plot edges.

Table 4: Secondary error-taxonomy counts at $\tau = 0.5$.

Site	Method	Over-seg.	Under-seg.	Missed	Leakage-flagged TP
Ettenheim	ForestMamba	1	4	11	10
Ettenheim	SegmentAnyTree	1	4	31	42
Mathislewald	ForestMamba	0	6	139	18
Mathislewald	SegmentAnyTree	1	1	169	12

ForestMamba's macro–plot gap flips sign between sites: macro hard F1 88.3% (95% CI 83.2-92.9) versus plot F1 70.3% at Ettenheim, but 22.8% (17.3-28.4) versus 37.0% at Mathislewald; SegmentAnyTree stays nearer its plot scores (67.5% versus 64.2%; 8.7% versus 14.5%; Table 5; Figure 10). Macro inflation at Ettenheim becomes macro deflation at Mathislewald.

Table 5: Plot-level F1 versus macro hard F1 at $\tau = 0.5$.

Site	Method	Plot F1	Macro hard F1	95% CI
Ettenheim	ForestMamba	70.3	88.3	83.2-92.9
Ettenheim	SegmentAnyTree	64.2	67.5	60.9-74.0
Mathislewald	ForestMamba	37.0	22.8	17.3-28.4
Mathislewald	SegmentAnyTree	14.5	8.7	5.1-12.3

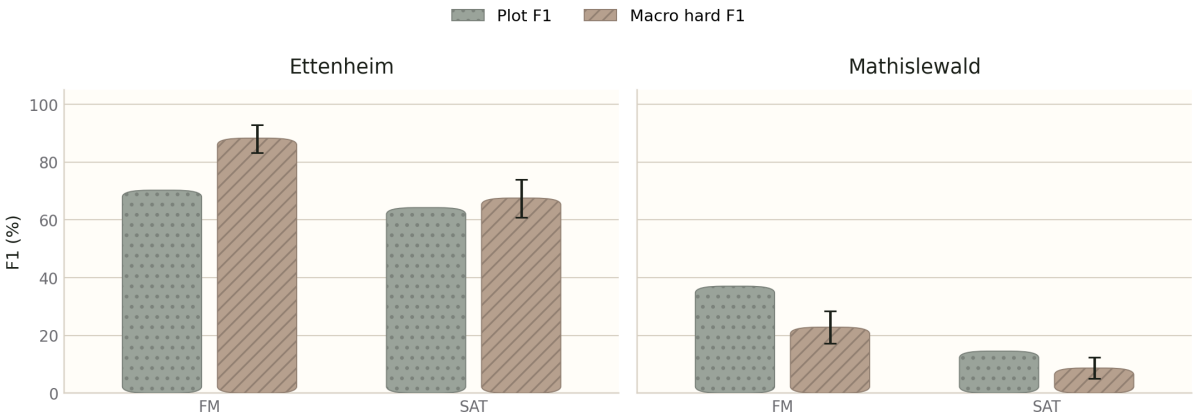


Figure 10: Plot-level F1 versus macro hard F1 for ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree at Ettenheim and Mathislewald ($\tau = 0.5$). Error bars are bootstrap 95% intervals on macro hard F1.

5.3.2 Assignment of inventory stems to trees

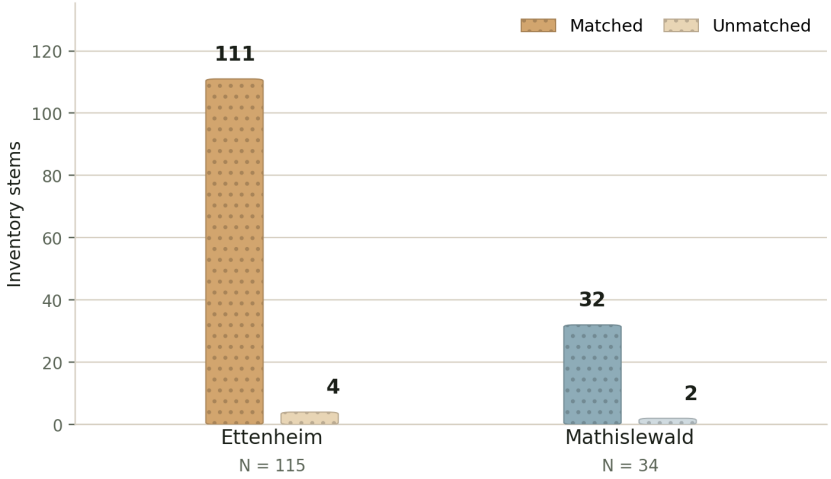


Figure 11: Counts of inventory stems that entered an exclusive match versus inventory stems that remained unmatched after geometric and visual review.

Exclusive matching retained 111 Ettenheim and 32 Mathislewald inventory stems (Figure 11; Table 6). At Mathislewald the large unmatched-layer count (157 of 189) is expected: the subplot has many more manual trees than the 34 inventoried stems, so most unmatched layers simply lack a field partner.

Table 6: Exclusive assignment counts linking inventory stems to trees on the analysed subplots (species / DetailView population in Figure 8).

Site	Inventory in extent	Matched	Unmatched inv.	Manual layers	Unmatched layers
Ettenheim	115	111	4	128	17
Mathislewald	34	32	2	189	157

5.3.3 Species classification with DetailView

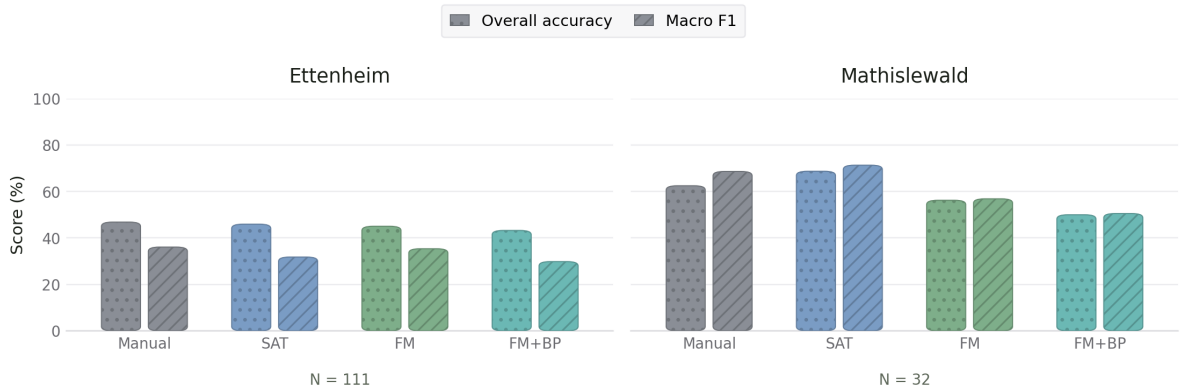


Figure 12: DetailView overall accuracy and macro F1 by instance source for Ettenheim ($N = 111$) and Mathislewald ($N = 32$).

Table 7: DetailView stem-level leaderboard. Overall accuracy (OA) and macro metrics are percentages. CI denotes the bootstrap 95% interval for OA.

Site	Instance source	N	OA	OA 95% CI	Macro P	Macro R	Macro F1
Ettenheim	Manual	111	46.8	36.9-55.9	49.6	35.1	36.1
Ettenheim	SegmentAnyTree	111	45.9	36.9-55.0	44.0	33.9	31.8
Ettenheim	ForestMamba	111	45.0	35.1-55.0	49.3	35.8	35.4
Ettenheim	ForestMamba+BluePoint	111	43.2	34.2-51.4	43.7	31.6	29.8
Mathislewald	Manual	32	62.5	46.8-78.1	86.7	57.9	68.7
Mathislewald	SegmentAnyTree	32	68.8	50.0-84.4	86.9	61.1	71.4
Mathislewald	ForestMamba	32	56.3	37.5-71.9	96.1	45.2	56.9
Mathislewald	ForestMamba+BluePoint	32	50.0	34.4-65.6	67.8	42.1	50.5
Both (pooled)	Manual	143	50.3	-	63.1	48.4	49.5
Both (pooled)	SegmentAnyTree	143	51.0	-	57.4	49.2	46.5
Both (pooled)	ForestMamba	143	47.6	-	61.8	49.4	47.8
Both (pooled)	ForestMamba+BluePoint	143	44.8	-	55.7	44.3	42.6

5.3.4 DetailView on manual instances

On the manual-instance track, overall accuracy was 46.8% at Ettenheim ($N = 111$; bootstrap 95% CI 36.9-55.9) and 62.5% at Mathislewald ($N = 32$; 46.8-78.1); macro F1 was 36.1% and 68.7% (Figure 12; Table 7). Class supports on the matched sets were: Ettenheim European beech 79, silver fir 17, Douglas fir 13, European larch 1, Norway spruce 1; Mathislewald Norway spruce 21, European beech 7, silver fir 4.

At Ettenheim the strongest manual-track diagonal entry was Douglas fir (92% of true stems predicted as Douglas fir); European beech was 42% on the diagonal, and silver fir was split mainly between correct silver fir (41%) and Douglas fir predictions (35%) (Figures 13 and 14). The single European larch stem and the single Norway spruce stem were each predicted entirely as Douglas fir. At Mathislewald, Norway spruce (67%), European beech (57%) and silver fir (50%) retained the largest correct fractions on the diagonal, with residual mass on neighbouring conifer and broadleaf labels.

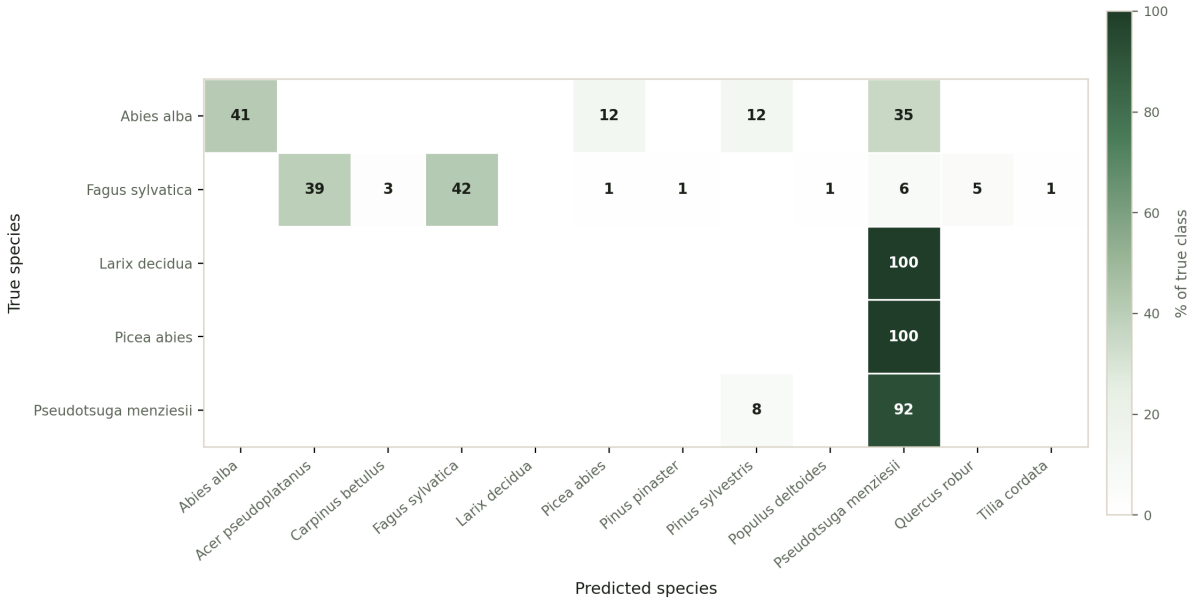


Figure 13: Ettenheim row-normalized DetailView confusion matrix on manual instances ($N = 111$).

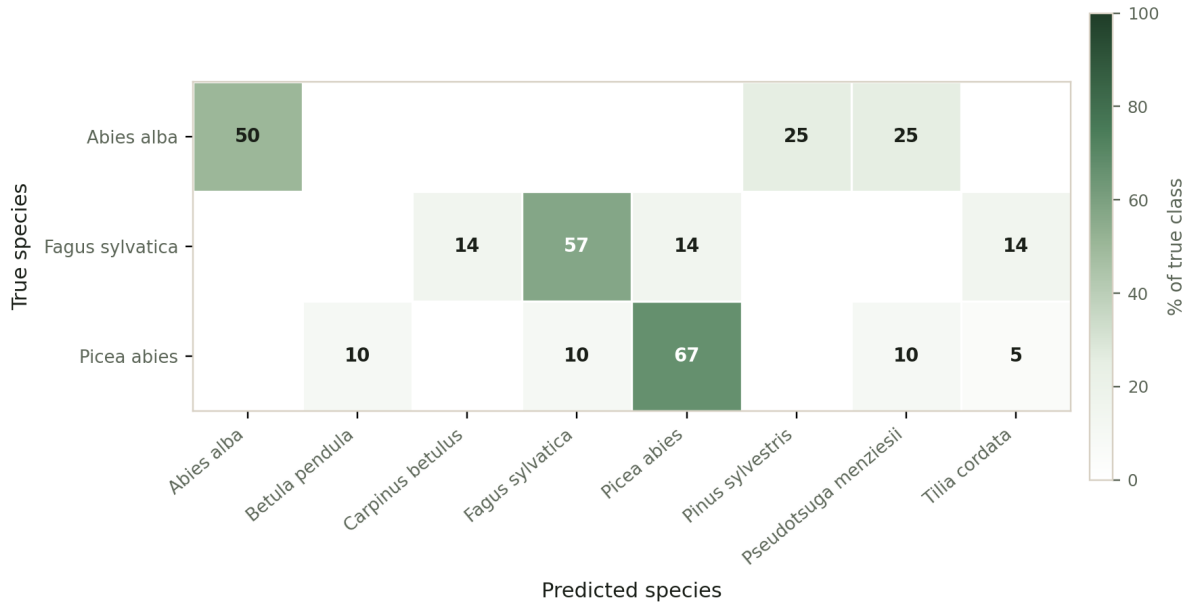


Figure 14: Mathislewald row-normalized DetailView confusion matrix on manual instances ($N = 32$).

5.4 Structural relationships

At Ettenheim ($N = 128$), hard F1 increased from short to tall trees for both models (ForestMamba tercile means 79.2% / 89.9% / 95.8%; SegmentAnyTree 51.5% / 64.1% / 86.9%; Figures 15, 16 and 17; Table 8). The Spearman association with height showed no clear evidence for ForestMamba ($\rho = 0.04$, $p = 0.68$) and met $p < 0.05$ for SegmentAnyTree ($\rho = 0.19$, $p = 0.032$). Nearest-neighbour distance among whole-tree centroids showed a clearer packing signal: crowded trees (low NN) had mean hard F1 of 75.0% (ForestMamba) and 41.9% (SegmentAnyTree), versus 97.5% and 87.2% in the most open tercile. Spearman ρ was 0.28 ($p = 0.0016$) for ForestMamba and 0.41 ($p < 0.001$) for SegmentAnyTree. Partial correlations residualising on $\log(1 + n_{\text{points}})$

remained positive (0.25 and 0.35). Whole-tree convex-hull volume tracked the same direction as size (ForestMamba terciles 74.5% / 93.0% / 97.5%; SegmentAnyTree 46.6% / 74.2% / 82.0%), but neither correlation provided clear evidence under $p < 0.05$ (ForestMamba $\rho = 0.08$, $p = 0.36$; SegmentAnyTree $\rho = 0.17$, $p = 0.052$).

Absolute hard F1 stayed near the floor in the low Mathislewald terciles ($N = 189$). Height and whole-tree convex-hull volume again separated success more strongly than nearest-neighbour spacing, but scores stayed much lower than at Ettenheim because most small reference trees were missed. ForestMamba hard F1 rose from 3.6% in the lowest height tercile to 53.1% in the highest ($\rho = 0.57$, $p < 0.001$). SegmentAnyTree rose from 0.0% to 21.2% ($\rho = 0.42$, $p < 0.001$). Hull-volume terciles were 0.0% / 11.2% / 57.3% for ForestMamba ($\rho = 0.64$, $p < 0.001$) and 0.0% / 2.3% / 23.8% for SegmentAnyTree ($\rho = 0.44$, $p < 0.001$). Nearest-neighbour distance met $p < 0.05$ for ForestMamba ($\rho = 0.31$, $p < 0.001$; open-tercile mean 41.3% versus 13.5% crowded) but showed no clear evidence for SegmentAnyTree ($\rho = 0.07$, $p = 0.35$; open 10.4% versus crowded 7.1%).

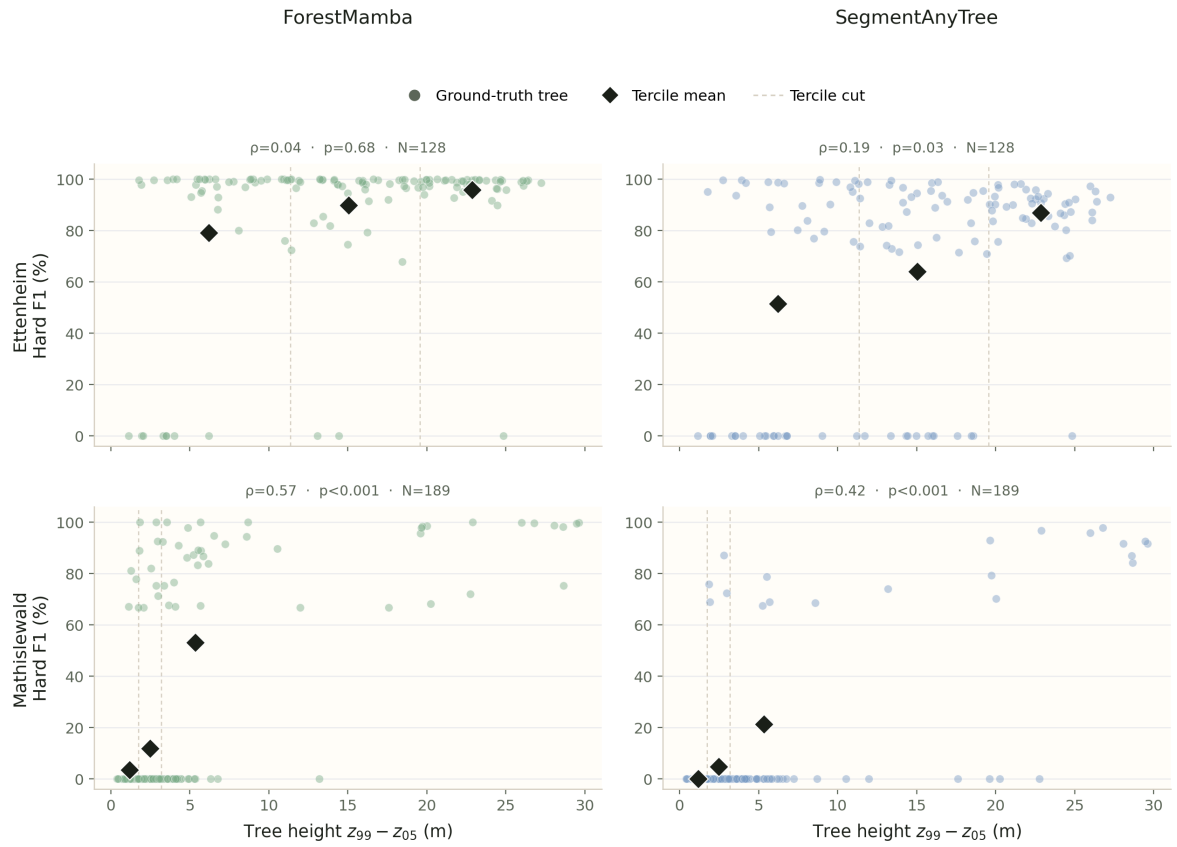


Figure 15: Per-tree hard F1 against tree height (z_{99}-z_{05}) for ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree at Ettenheim (top) and Mathislewald (bottom).

On the manual track, Ettenheim broadleaf overall accuracy was 41.8% ($N = 79$) and conifer overall accuracy was 59.4% ($N = 32$); Mathislewald broadleaf overall accuracy was 57.1% ($N = 7$) and conifer overall accuracy was 64.0% ($N = 25$) (Figures 18 and 19). Restricting to stems taller than 5 m gave manual-track overall accuracies of 46.3% at Ettenheim ($N = 108$) and 68.2% at

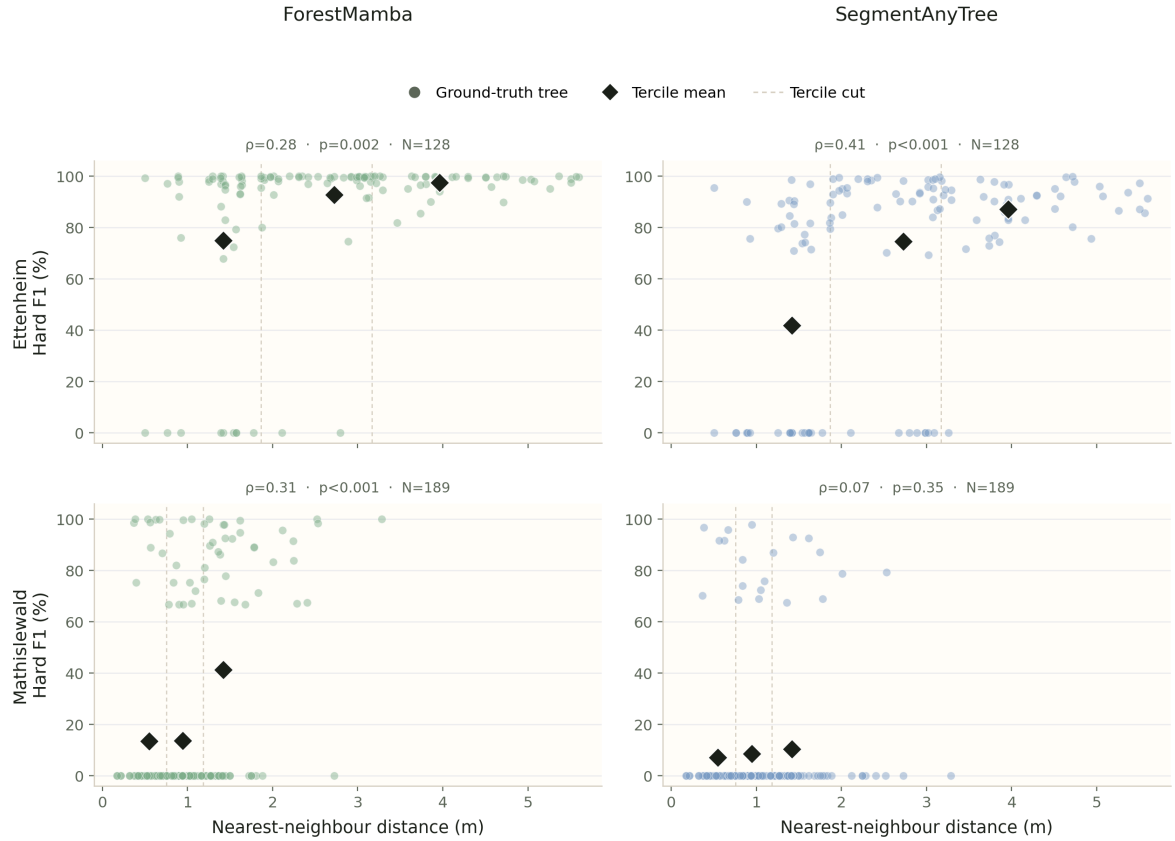


Figure 16: Per-tree hard F1 against planimetric nearest-neighbour distance between whole-tree centroids for ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree at Ettenheim (top) and Mathislewald (bottom).

Table 8: Mean per-tree hard F1 (%) by covariate tercile (low / mid / high). Tercile cuts are site-specific.

Site	Covariate	ForestMamba	SegmentAnyTree
Ettenheim	Height	79.2 / 89.9 / 95.8	51.5 / 64.1 / 86.9
Ettenheim	Nearest neighbour	75.0 / 92.8 / 97.5	41.9 / 74.5 / 87.2
Ettenheim	Whole-tree hull volume	74.5 / 93.0 / 97.5	46.6 / 74.2 / 82.0
Mathislewald	Height	3.6 / 11.8 / 53.1	0.0 / 4.8 / 21.2
Mathislewald	Nearest neighbour	13.5 / 13.7 / 41.3	7.1 / 8.6 / 10.4
Mathislewald	Whole-tree hull volume	0.0 / 11.2 / 57.3	0.0 / 2.3 / 23.8

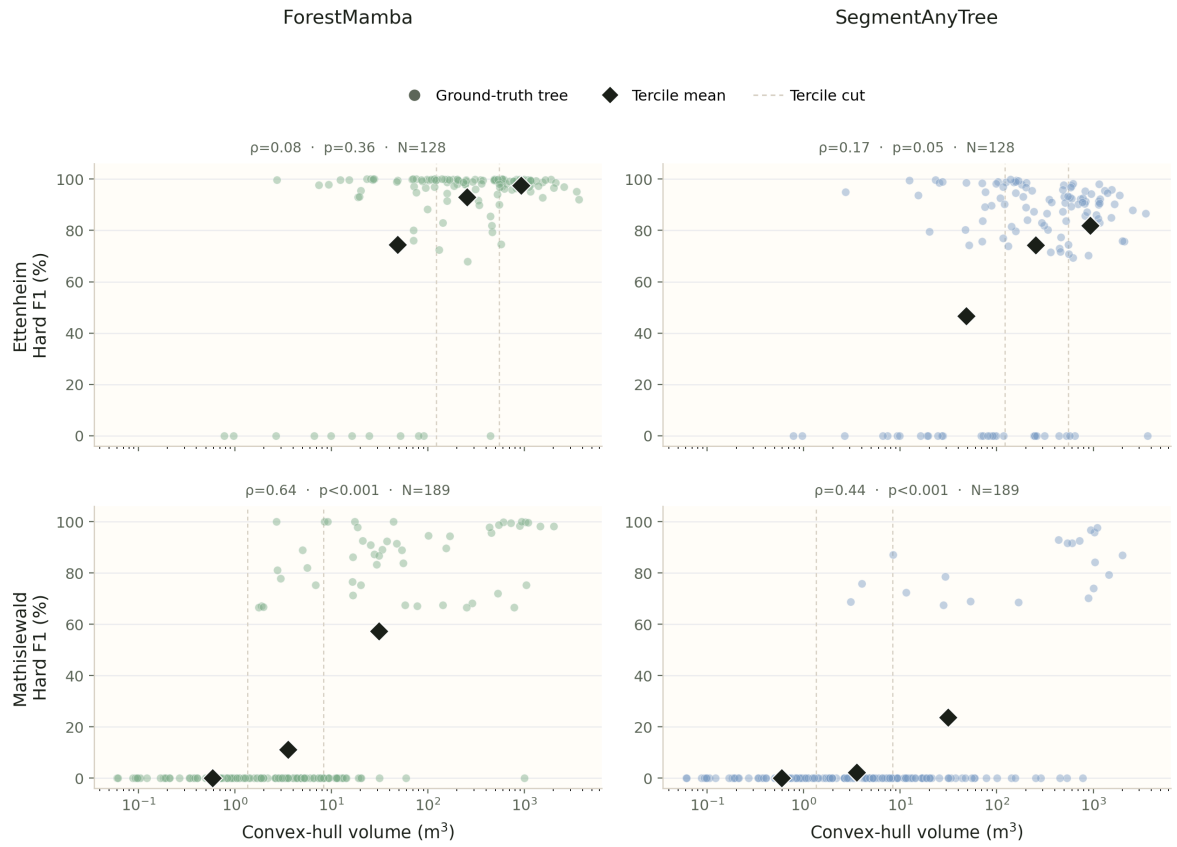


Figure 17: Per-tree hard F1 against whole-tree convex-hull volume (log x) for ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree at Ettenheim (top) and Mathislewald (bottom).

Mathislewald ($N = 22$). Spearman association between stem height and manual-track correctness showed no clear evidence at either site under $p < 0.05$ ($\rho = -0.04$, $p = 0.66$ at Ettenheim; $\rho = 0.21$, $p = 0.25$ at Mathislewald).

At Ettenheim, manual-track overall accuracy was 42.1% in the most crowded NN tercile, 41.7% in the mid tercile and 56.8% in the most open tercile ($N = 38/36/37$; Figures 20 and 21; Table 9). The Spearman link between NN distance and correctness was positive but showed no clear evidence under $p < 0.05$ ($\rho = 0.12$, $p = 0.21$). Automatic tracks likewise showed no clear evidence (SegmentAnyTree $\rho = 0.14$, $p = 0.16$; ForestMamba $\rho = 0.14$, $p = 0.15$; ForestMamba+BluePoint $\rho = 0.13$, $p = 0.17$). Whole-tree convex-hull volume showed the opposite gradient: manual OA fell from 64.9% (low volume) through 45.9% (mid) to 29.7% (high volume), with Spearman $\rho = -0.28$ ($p = 0.0030$). ForestMamba ($\rho = -0.27$, $p = 0.0048$) and ForestMamba+BluePoint ($\rho = -0.20$, $p = 0.036$) reproduced the same decline. SegmentAnyTree showed no clear evidence under $p < 0.05$ ($\rho = -0.12$, $p = 0.21$).

At Mathislewald ($N = 32$), manual OA was 36.4% in the crowded NN tercile, 81.8% mid and 70.0% open ($\rho = 0.24$, $p = 0.18$). Automatic tracks also showed no clear evidence under $p < 0.05$ (SegmentAnyTree $\rho = 0.18$, $p = 0.32$; ForestMamba $\rho = -0.017$, $p = 0.93$; ForestMamba+BluePoint $\rho = -0.091$, $p = 0.62$). Hull-volume terciles were 45.5% / 80.0% / 63.6% with no clear rank association under $p < 0.05$ (manual $\rho = 0.17$, $p = 0.36$; SegmentAnyTree

$\rho = -0.015$, $p = 0.94$; ForestMamba $\rho = -0.048$, $p = 0.80$; ForestMamba+BluePoint $\rho = -0.14$, $p = 0.46$). With about ten stems per bin, these Mathislewald strata are directional only.

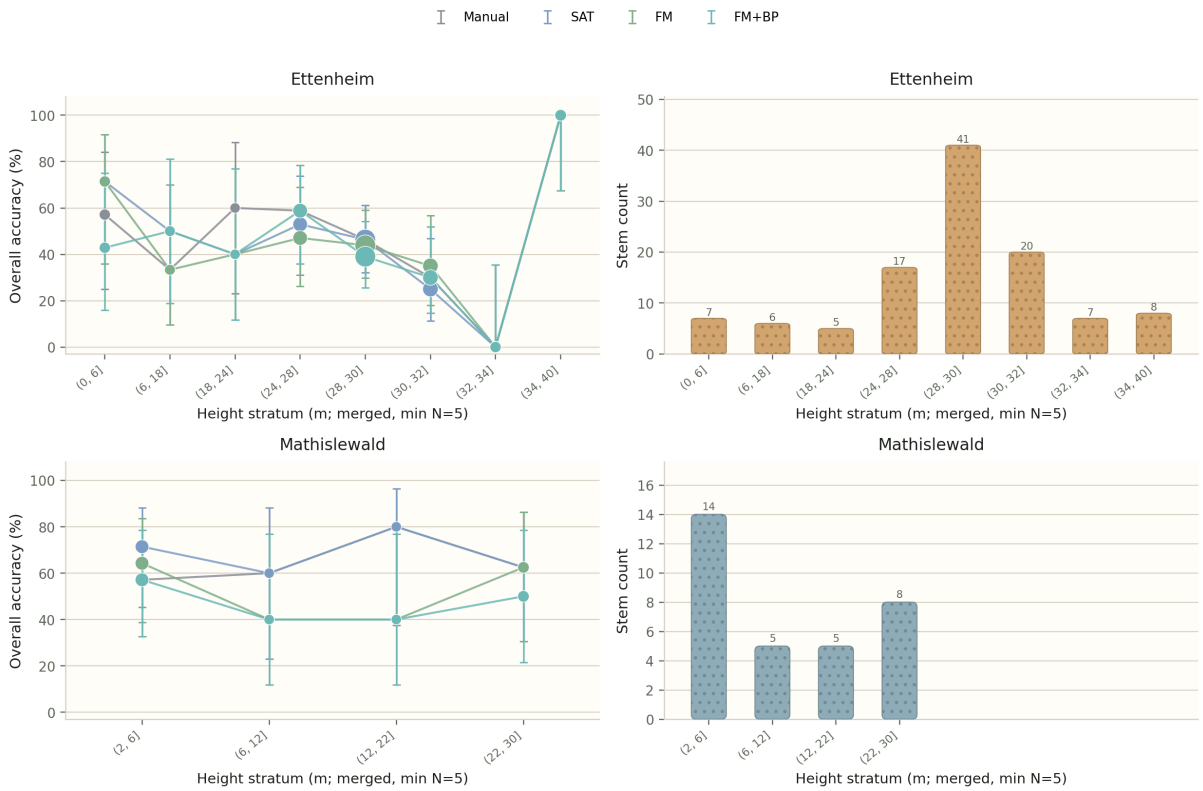


Figure 18: DetailView overall accuracy by merged height strata for each site and instance source (adjacent 2 m bins combined until $N \geq 5$; Wilson 95% intervals; marker size scales with N).

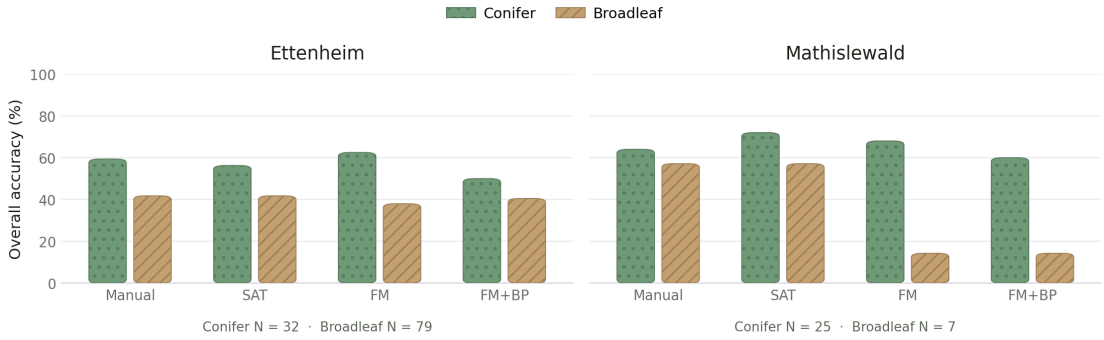


Figure 19: DetailView overall accuracy for broadleaf and conifer stems by site and instance source.

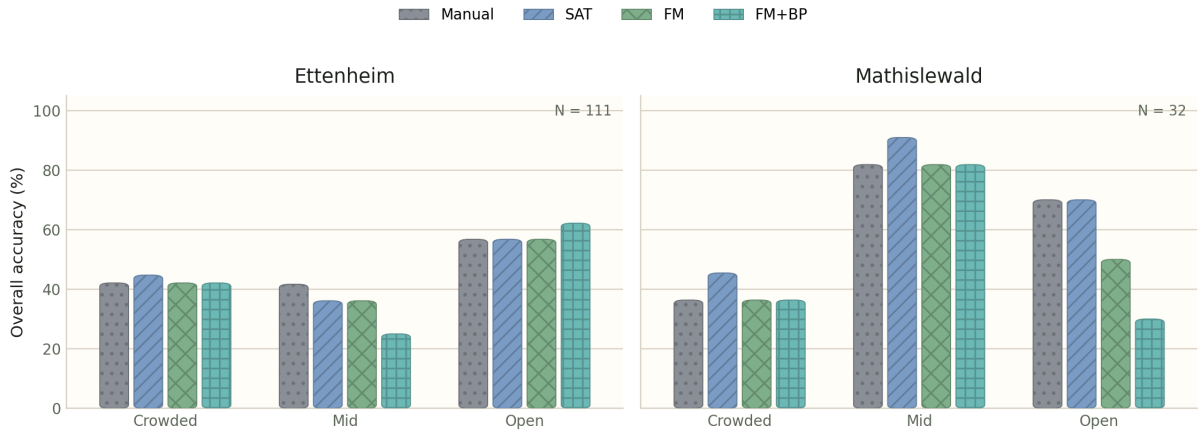


Figure 20: DetailView overall accuracy by nearest-neighbour tercile (site-specific cuts) for each instance source. Low NN denotes crowded trees (short distance between whole-tree centroids). High NN denotes more open neighbourhoods.

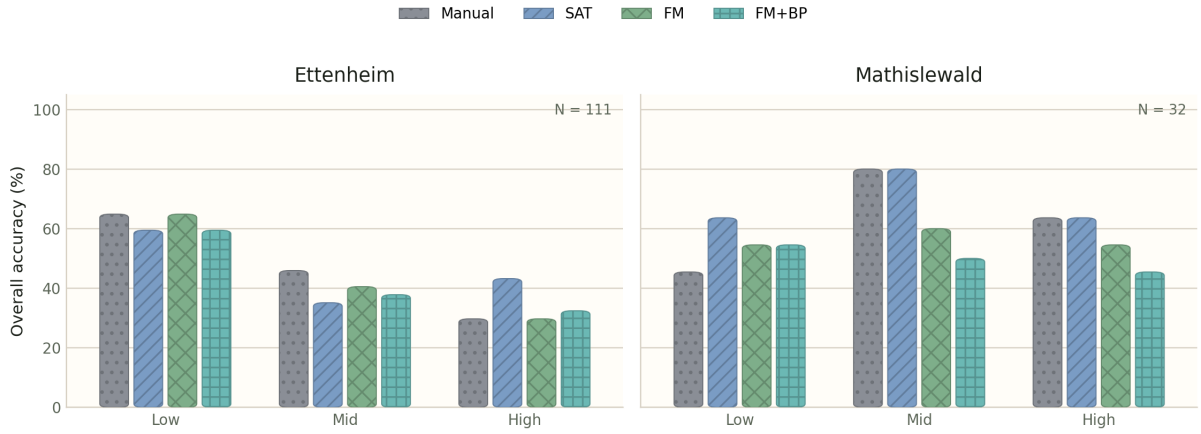


Figure 21: DetailView overall accuracy by whole-tree convex-hull volume tercile for each site and instance source.

Table 9: Manual-track DetailView overall accuracy (%) by structural tercile on inventory-matched stems.

Site	Covariate	Low / crowded	Mid	High / open
Ettenheim	Nearest neighbour	42.1	41.7	56.8
Ettenheim	Whole-tree hull volume	64.9	45.9	29.7
Mathislewald	Nearest neighbour	36.4	81.8	70.0
Mathislewald	Whole-tree hull volume	45.5	80.0	63.6

5.5 Segmentation-to-species effects

On the shared stems, Ettenheim Manual − automatic ΔOA was +0.9 percentage points for SegmentAnyTree (paired bootstrap 95% CI −7.2 to +9.0), +1.8 for ForestMamba (−3.6 to +8.1) and +3.6 for ForestMamba+BluePoint (−3.6 to +10.8), with ForestMamba+BluePoint − ForestMamba at −1.8 (−9.0 to +5.4; Figure 22; Table 10). Mathislewald yielded −6.3 (−15.6 to 0.0), +6.3 (−6.3 to +18.8), +12.5 (−3.1 to +31.3) and −6.3 (−18.8 to +3.1) on the same four contrasts. SegmentAnyTree alone flips sign between sites (manual slightly ahead at Ettenheim; automatic ahead at Mathislewald); with $N = 32$, those Mathislewald intervals stay wide.

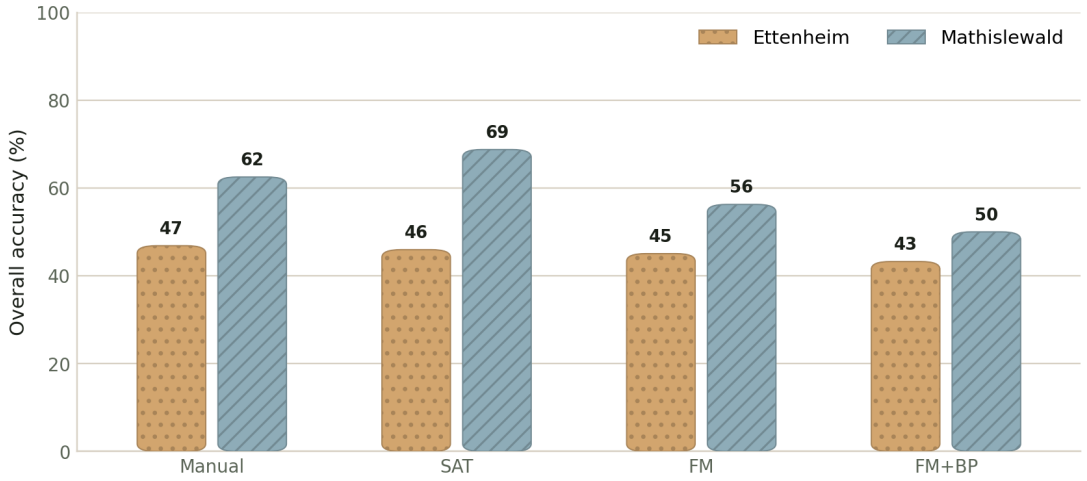


Figure 22: DetailView overall accuracy as a function of instance source for Ettenheim and Mathislewald.

Table 10: DetailView overall-accuracy differences ΔOA (percentage points; manual minus automatic, except the last row) with paired bootstrap 95% intervals on the shared stems.

Contrast	Ettenheim	Mathislewald
Manual − SegmentAnyTree	+0.9 [−7.2, +9.0]	−6.3 [−15.6, 0.0]
Manual − ForestMamba	+1.8 [−3.6, +8.1]	+6.3 [−6.3, +18.8]
Manual − ForestMamba+BluePoint	+3.6 [−3.6, +10.8]	+12.5 [−3.1, +31.3]
ForestMamba+BluePoint − ForestMamba	−1.8 [−9.0, +5.4]	−6.3 [−18.8, +3.1]

Manual–ForestMamba stem-level DetailView agreement was high at both sites (78.4% Ettenheim; 81.3% Mathislewald; Table 11). The remaining Ettenheim pairs were manual versus SegmentAnyTree 65.8%, manual versus ForestMamba+BluePoint 72.1% and ForestMamba versus ForestMamba+BluePoint 77.5%; at Mathislewald, manual versus SegmentAnyTree was also 81.3%, while manual versus ForestMamba+BluePoint dipped to 65.6% and ForestMamba versus ForestMamba+BluePoint was 78.1%.

At Ettenheim, Douglas fir F1 remained comparatively high across tracks, whereas silver fir and European beech F1 declined under ForestMamba and ForestMamba+BluePoint relative to the

Table 11: Stem-level DetailView species-label agreement (%) between instance tracks.

Pair	Ettenheim ($N = 111$)	Mathislewald ($N = 32$)
Manual vs SegmentAnyTree	65.8	81.3
Manual vs ForestMamba	78.4	81.3
Manual vs ForestMamba+BluePoint	72.1	65.6
ForestMamba vs ForestMamba+BluePoint	77.5	78.1

manual track (Figure 23). At Mathislewald, Norway spruce F1 stayed high under SegmentAnyTree and declined under ForestMamba+BluePoint. European beech and silver fir F1 varied with instance source on the smaller supports.

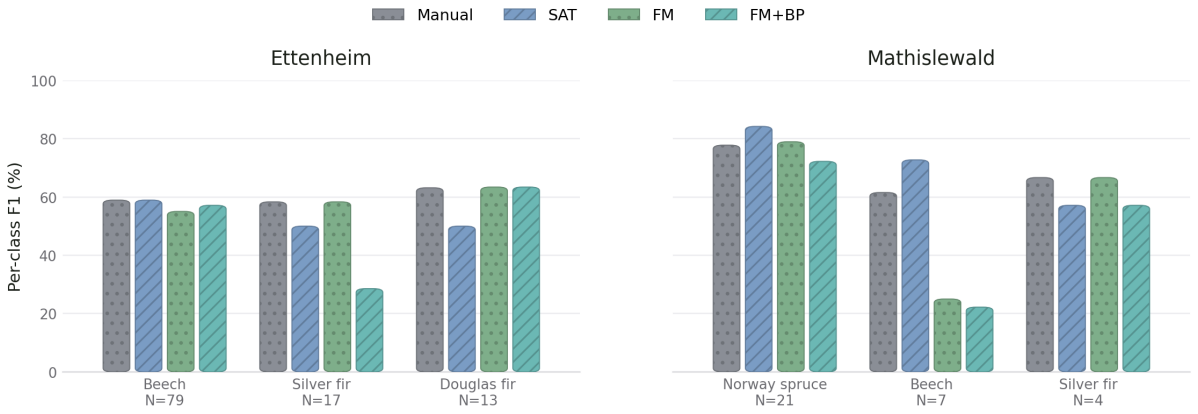


Figure 23: DetailView per-class F1 by instance source for taxa with inventory support $N \geq 3$ at Ettenheim and Mathislewald. Singleton stems ($N = 1$) are omitted.

6 Discussion

6.1 Overall performance

Mathislewald packs more trees into a smaller footprint than any Ettenheim tile, so the same matching protocol faces a denser, more fragmented object set. Segmentation N_{GT} and inventory-matched stems are different populations (Figure 8): the former denominates recall; the latter is the DetailView set.

ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree share the manual reference point support, so metric gaps reflect label assignment on shared geometry. Residual inventory-to-TLS offsets add the assignment uncertainty noted under Limitations.

At $\tau = 0.5$, ForestMamba recall was high at Ettenheim (91.4%) but only 26.5% at Mathislewald against the full 189-tree reference, still ahead of SegmentAnyTree (75.8%; 10.6%). Precision diverged by site: ForestMamba over-predicted at Ettenheim (precision 57.1%) and kept moderate precision at Mathislewald (61.7%) while missing most reference trees; SegmentAnyTree was

moderate at Ettenheim (55.7%) and collapsed at Mathislewald (23.3%). Absolute Mathislewald F1 scores remain low for both models even though ForestMamba ranks ahead.

At Ettenheim, ForestMamba behaves like a high-recall detector; at Mathislewald its recall collapses once many small reference trees must each be recovered as their own object. SegmentAnyTree stays competitive at Ettenheim but collapses at Mathislewald on the same small, low-volume trees (nearest-neighbour packing shows no clear association with SegmentAnyTree hard F1 there).

Ettenheim also hides tile-level heterogeneity behind the plot aggregate (Table 3; Figure A.1). Error centroids sit through subplot interiors as well as edges, so operational thresholds need tile-aware checks beyond plot means.

IoU threshold sweeps sharpen the same contrast: Ettenheim ForestMamba is relatively stable across τ, while SegmentAnyTree and both Mathislewald tracks drop more as the gate tightens. Both leave many Mathislewald reference trees with low or zero overlap, so raising τ removes many of the remaining true positives.

Over- and under-segmentation counts are small relative to misses and leakage-flagged true positives (Table 4). SegmentAnyTree's elevated leakage-flag rate at Ettenheim, despite usable F1, shows that many accepted objects remain geometrically impure. At Mathislewald the dominant failure for both models is missing most reference trees, with false-negative centroids spread through the subplot and not confined to edges (Figure A.7).

Macro hard F1 and plot F1 diverge by site. At Ettenheim, ForestMamba macro hard F1 exceeds plot F1: strong delineation among detected trees, but a large false-positive penalty at plot scale. At Mathislewald, macro hard F1 sits below plot F1 because many zero-scoring misses pull the per-tree mean down. Ettenheim ForestMamba can therefore combine a detection-heavy error mode with high per-tree overlap once a match exists; at Mathislewald, misses dominate and the per-tree mean falls while plot F1 stays relatively higher.

Under the shared protocol ForestMamba scores higher on both sites on this reference. Because editing began from preliminary ForestMamba instances, that ranking is conditional on reference construction and should not be read as unconditional superiority over SegmentAnyTree on independently delineated ground truth. Those detection-versus-delineation differences matter when inventory products assume one predicted object per physical tree under this matching style, and they sit beside the match spreads reported in recent TLS benchmarks (Cherlet et al., 2026).

On inventory-matched stems under manual instances, DetailView overall accuracy stayed well below published FOR-species20K test performance even with manually refined instances ($N = 111$ Ettenheim; $N = 32$ Mathislewald) (Puliti et al., 2025). Taxonomic transfer, class imbalance and open-set predictions dominate the error budget before any change of instance source (Fassnacht et al., 2016).

Beech drives most of the Ettenheim failure: Douglas fir reached about 92% on the confusion-matrix diagonal, while European beech reached only about 42% despite majority support (Figures 13 and 14). Silver fir split mainly between correct silver fir and Douglas fir. That pattern is

consistent with a 33-class European head without local recalibration. At Mathislewald, higher overall accuracy fits stronger recovery of the local majority conifer (Norway spruce about 67% on the diagonal) and a smaller broadleaf share; with $N = 32$, off-diagonal cells should be read as directional rates. On this baseline, taxonomic transfer and class imbalance constrain accuracy more than geometric instance quality.

6.2 Structural relationships

Exploratory Spearman associations separate two site-specific segmentation failure regimes.

At Ettenheim, packing dominates per-tree hard F1: Spearman ρ with nearest-neighbour distance is 0.28 ($p = 0.0016$) for ForestMamba and 0.41 ($p < 0.001$) for SegmentAnyTree; both stay positive after residualising on point count. Crowded trees lose roughly 22 percentage points of ForestMamba hard F1 and 45 points of SegmentAnyTree hard F1 relative to the most open tercile. Height and hull-volume associations show no clear evidence under $p < 0.05$ for ForestMamba, so a height cutoff alone would discard little of its residual error.

At Mathislewald the ranking shifts toward size. Height and whole-tree convex-hull volume dominate (ForestMamba $\rho = 0.57$ and 0.64; SegmentAnyTree $\rho = 0.42$ and 0.44; all $p < 0.001$). Absolute scores stay low even in the upper height terciles (53.1% ForestMamba; 21.2% SegmentAnyTree). Ettenheim errors concentrate where neighbours are close; Mathislewald errors concentrate on small occupancy.

Those same axes organise DetailView correctness differently. Height stratification barely moved species OA, and Spearman links with correctness showed no clear evidence under $p < 0.05$ at either site. Lifeform collapse at Ettenheim favoured conifers over broadleaves (59.4% versus 41.8%); the Mathislewald broadleaf subset ($N = 7$) is too small for a stable contrast. Height filtering alone does not restore species performance.

Nearest-neighbour packing and whole-tree hull volume also diverge from the segmentation story. At Ettenheim, open neighbourhoods only weakly improve species OA ($\rho = 0.12$, $p = 0.21$), with no clear evidence that free space is a taxonomic quality filter even though it improves geometric F1 (Figures A.8 and A.9). Whole-tree hull volume shows a clear inverse association with manual OA ($\rho = -0.28$, $p = 0.003$). Large-occupancy matched stems there are mostly European beech, so the hull-volume gradient largely rediscovers the beech failure, not a pure geometric bulk effect. ForestMamba and ForestMamba+BluePoint reproduce the same decline.

At Mathislewald, with $N = 32$ and roughly ten stems per bin, packing and hull strata warrant cautious reading and are a poor swap for Ettenheim packing rules. Covariates that help segmentation (packing at Ettenheim; size at Mathislewald) transfer poorly as predictors of DetailView correctness.

6.3 Segmentation-to-species effects

On the matched-stem ablation (classification given instances, not an end-to-end species map), Ettenheim overall-accuracy gaps versus the manual track stayed within a few percentage points

and paired bootstrap 95% intervals included zero. Mathislewald signed gaps were larger but intervals are wide ($N = 32$). BluePoint did not improve species OA relative to ForestMamba and reduced macro F1 on both sites.

Stem-level label agreement was high for several pairs (Table 11), so many stems keep the same label across instance sources: segmentation error reassigns a minority of decisions and leaves the taxonomic map largely intact. Class-level shifts can still occur when plot-level OA looks nearly flat: at Ettenheim, Douglas fir stays comparatively stable while beech and silver fir absorb more automatic-track degradation (Figure 23; Figures A.10 and A.11). Closing the taxonomic gap on these matched stems is unlikely without local adaptation of the species head (or an explicit open-set policy) and a larger matched sample (Fassnacht et al., 2016; Puliti et al., 2025).

6.4 Limitations

Manual delineation had no peer review or double annotation. Thin branches, interlocking crowns and suppressed stems remain ambiguous, and residual layer errors can persist in a single-annotator reference (Burt et al., 2019; Wilkes et al., 2017). Without an independent re-annotation control, model scores are distances to this delineation, not to a consensus reference.

Inventory assignment retained a visual component where markers were offset from breast-height centroids, which adds error where neighbouring stems have similar DBH or height (Kükenbrink et al., 2022; Liu et al., 2018). Exclusive one-to-one matching also approximates a stem census that inventory and TLS may define inconsistently.

Not all clipped subplots were annotated, so the analysed footprints are smaller than the archives. Starting from preliminary ForestMamba instances leaves a residual risk that the reference may inherit ForestMamba's merge and split habits on ambiguous crowns; overall instance ranking is conditional on this reference and does not prove ForestMamba superior on independently delineated ground truth (Cherlet et al., 2026).

Species scores inherit inventory omission, positional noise and the local species list (Fassnacht et al., 2016). DetailView was applied off-the-shelf without retraining or label-set restriction, so open-set predictions are expected. Each site used a single TLS modality; cross-platform splits were out of scope. Bootstrap intervals capture sampling uncertainty on matched stems but not reference-label uncertainty or spatial autocorrelation within contiguous subplots.

6.5 Scope and generalizability

This is a local benchmark on two university research forests in southwestern Germany: a larger beech-dominated mixed stand at Ettenheim and a smaller spruce-dominated subplot at Mathislewald. Claims do not transfer automatically to airborne-only inventories or other biomes without new references. Within temperate mixed TLS settings, the useful takeaways are relative ForestMamba versus SegmentAnyTree behaviour under a shared protocol, including the site split between packing-dominated hard F1 at Ettenheim and size-dominated hard F1 at Mathislewald, how far segmentation error reaches inventory-matched species labels, and the cost of building usable geometric and taxonomic references. Comparing two ecologically distinct sites strengthens

those takeaways; the small matched N at Mathislewald, partial subplot coverage and missing independent re-annotation still limit how far absolute scores or species strata can travel.

6.6 Implications

The results favour site-specific structural checks for quality assurance (QA) over naming a single preferred model. At Ettenheim, nearest-neighbour packing is a useful geometric QA cue; at Mathislewald, object size and whole-tree hull volume are more informative than residual centroid spacing. For detection-oriented use, ForestMamba is workable at plot scale on the Ettenheim scenes if false positives are acceptable or filterable, but Mathislewald recall against the full 189-tree reference shows that many small trees remain undetected. For delineation-sensitive products, leakage-flag and τ-sweep diagnostics belong beside headline F1. SegmentAnyTree remains a useful Ettenheim baseline; under this protocol it trails ForestMamba sharply on denser Mathislewald.

Off-the-shelf DetailView still needs field taxonomy on these forests. Fine-tuning to local labels, or human oversight, is still needed before automated species layers support management or ecological inference. Instance-source effects stay modest relative to the manual-instance taxonomic gap, and free-space or hull-volume filters leave beech performance unrecovered at Ettenheim. The paired manual-plus-inventory reference and dual instance/species protocol can be reused on other research forests that already hold TLS and stem maps.

6.7 Future research

Priority extensions are: (i) complete annotation of remaining clipped subplots and additional stands, with an independent re-annotation control sample; (ii) enlarge the inventory-matched species set and test DetailView variants restricted or recalibrated to local taxa, with confidence gating and explicit open-set handling (Puliti et al., 2025); (iii) repeat the instance benchmark with fully independent manual delineation on a subset and with additional or fine-tuned predictors (Henrich et al., 2024; Xiang et al., 2025); (iv) add ULS or other platform tracks under the same matched stems, following related cross-platform species and instance benchmarks (Wielgosz et al., 2024); and (v) release reference clouds, match manifests and evaluation scripts under a clear license. Structural DBH/height error budgets and multi-temporal revisit follow once instance and species layers are stable (Calders et al., 2015; Liu et al., 2018).

7 Conclusions

Across Ettenheim and Mathislewald, ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree were scored for delineation and DetailView for species on the manually refined TLS references, with inventory linkage where exclusive matching succeeded. The clearest pattern is structural: misses track size and crowding more than instance-track choice.

Under the shared protocol, ForestMamba ranked ahead on both sites, while SegmentAnyTree stayed competitive at Ettenheim but weaker at Mathislewald (RQ1). Those rankings are conditional on a reference edited from preliminary ForestMamba instances. Detection-versus-

delineation diagnostics show how the models differ when misses dominate the denser subplot, beyond what headline F1 summarises. On inventory-matched stems under manual instances, off-the-shelf DetailView reached only about 47% overall accuracy at Ettenheim ($N = 111$) and about 62.5% at Mathislewald; open-set transfer and local class imbalance dominate that gap.

Structural error splits by site (RQ2). At Ettenheim, residual geometric error concentrates where whole-tree centroids are tightly packed (crowded trees lose roughly 22 and 45 percentage points of ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree hard F1 relative to the most open tercile). At Mathislewald, height and whole-tree convex-hull volume dominate: both models miss most small, low-volume reference trees. Those same segmentation covariates predict DetailView correctness poorly: free space showed no clear species benefit at Ettenheim, and large hull volume there tracked poorer labels mainly through majority beech failure.

On the matched-stem ablation (RQ3), changing the instance track moved overall accuracy only modestly at Ettenheim and by noisier amounts at the smaller Mathislewald set. Closing the taxonomic gap on these stems still needs local adaptation beyond better segmentation.

The paired geometric and inventory reference, with the dual instance/species chain, remains usable as a local benchmark on other TLS research forests. Next priorities (independent re-annotation, larger matched samples, local species-head adaptation, and cross-platform tracks) are spelled out as Future research (i)–(v).

* * *

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A Supplementary diagnostic figures

This appendix collects repetitive instance-segmentation diagnostics and species panels that duplicate main-text summaries. Plot-level scores, structural hard-F1 associations (height, nearest-neighbour packing, whole-tree hull volume), and the primary DetailView species figures remain in Section 5.

A.1 Instance-segmentation diagnostics

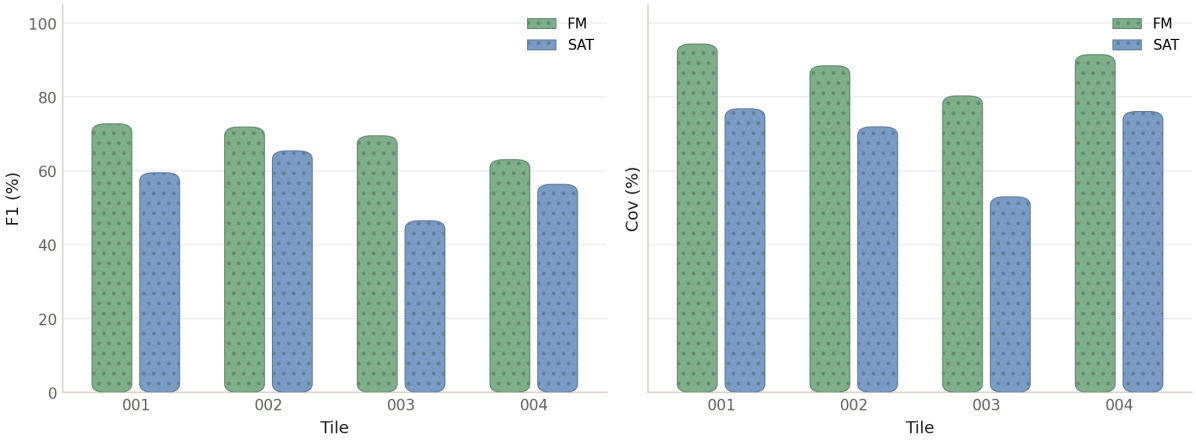


Figure A.1: Ettenheim per-subplot F1-score and coverage at $\tau = 0.5$ for ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree.

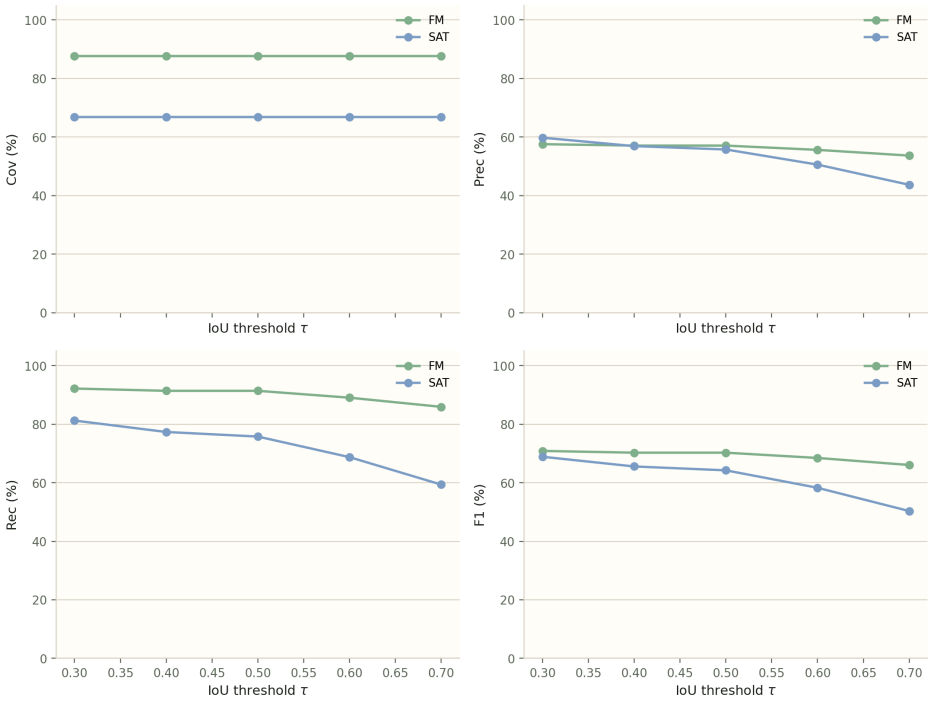


Figure A.2: Ettenheim instance metrics as a function of the IoU matching threshold τ.

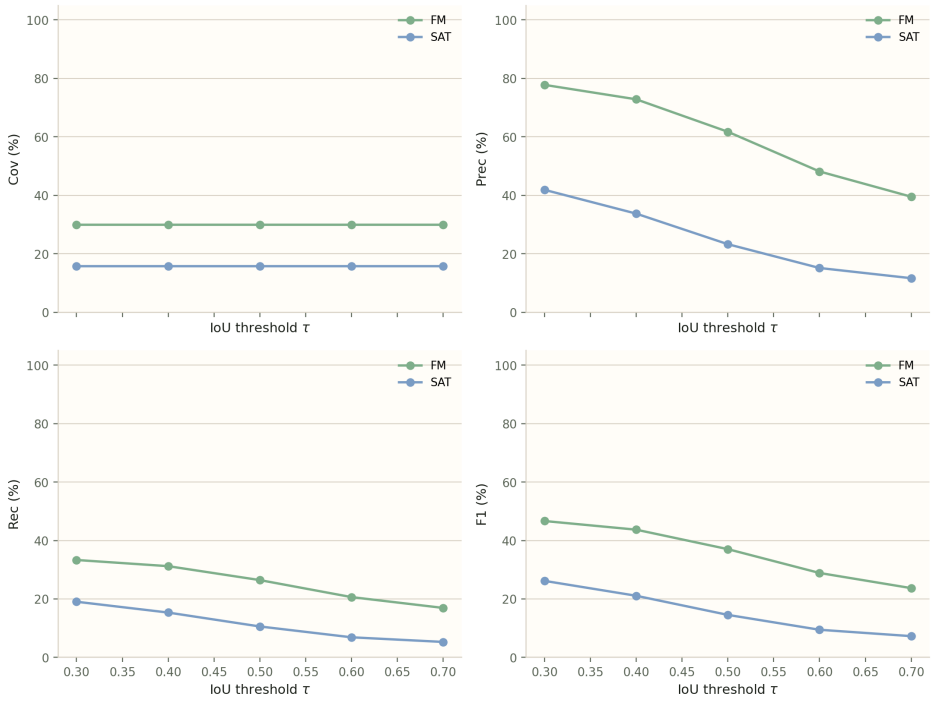


Figure A.3: Mathislewald instance metrics as a function of the IoU matching threshold τ.

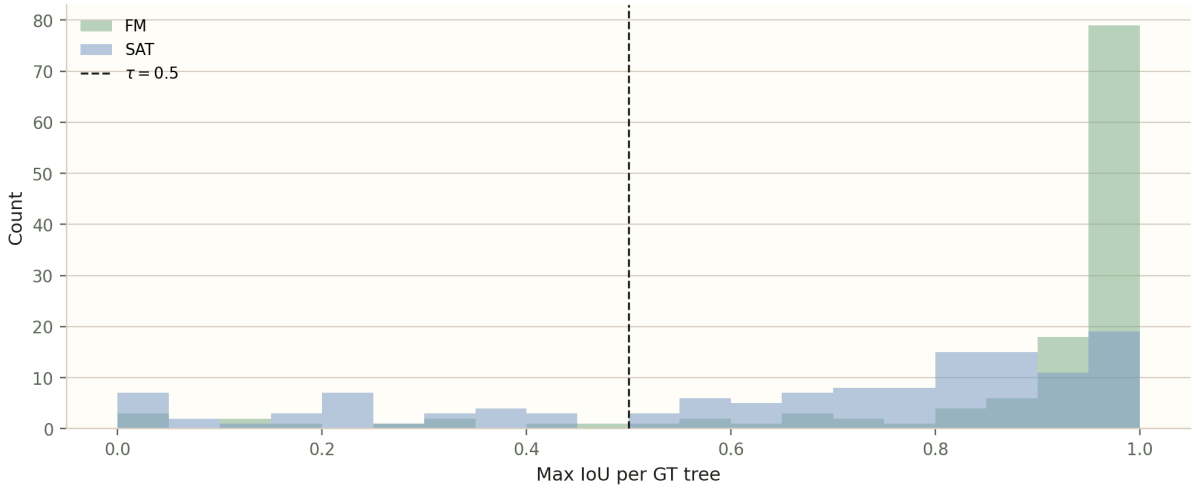


Figure A.4: Ettenheim distribution of per-ground-truth maximum IoU against ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree.

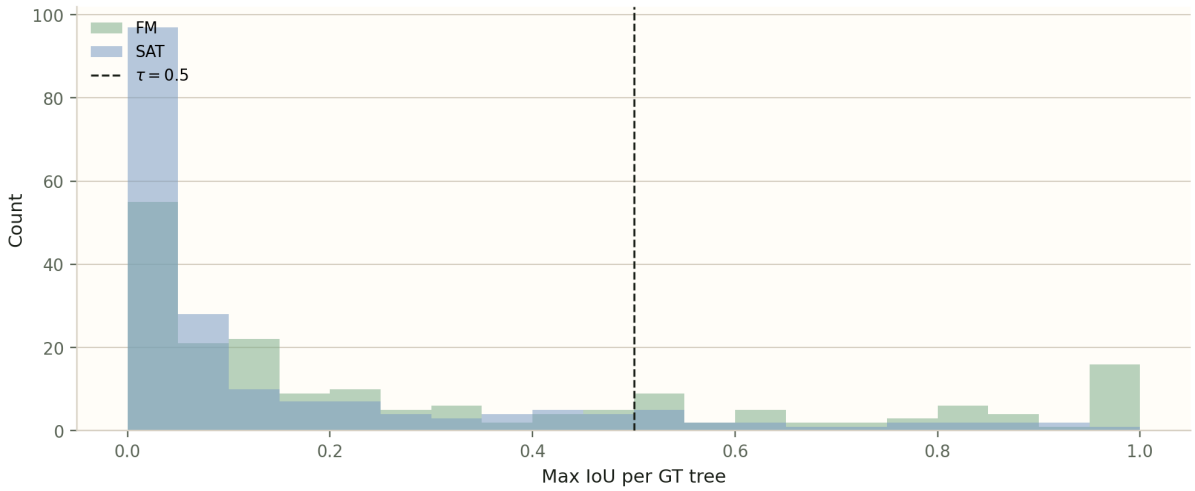


Figure A.5: Mathislewald distribution of per-ground-truth maximum IoU against ForestMamba and SegmentAnyTree.

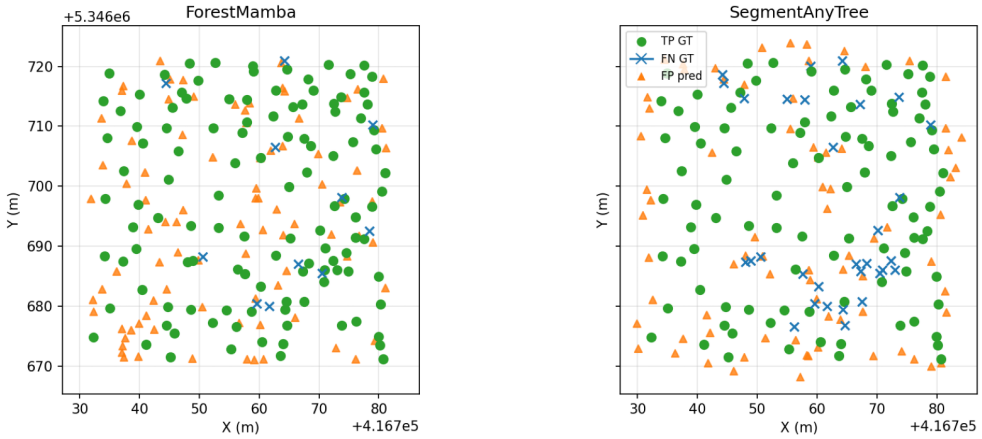


Figure A.6: Ettenheim plan view of true-positive, false-negative and false-positive instance centroids at $\tau = 0.5$.

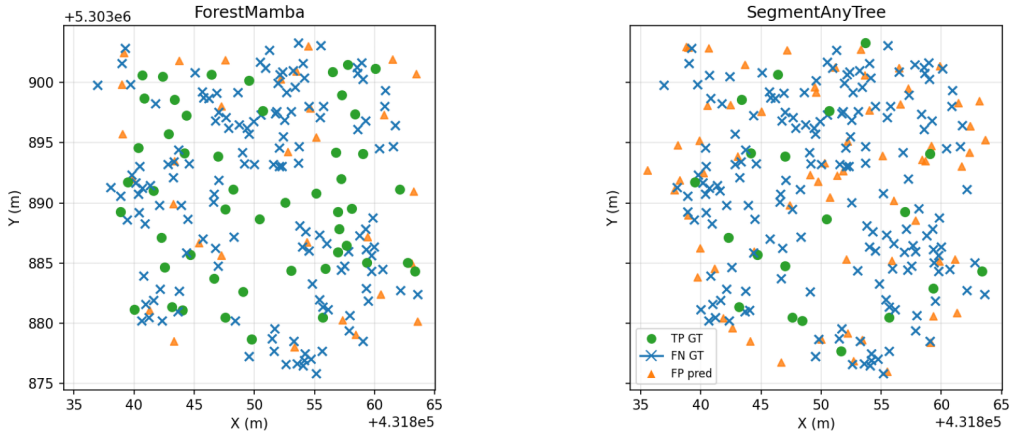


Figure A.7: Mathislewald plan view of true-positive, false-negative and false-positive instance centroids at $\tau = 0.5$. Missed ground-truth trees dominate both panels.

A.2 Species supplementary panels

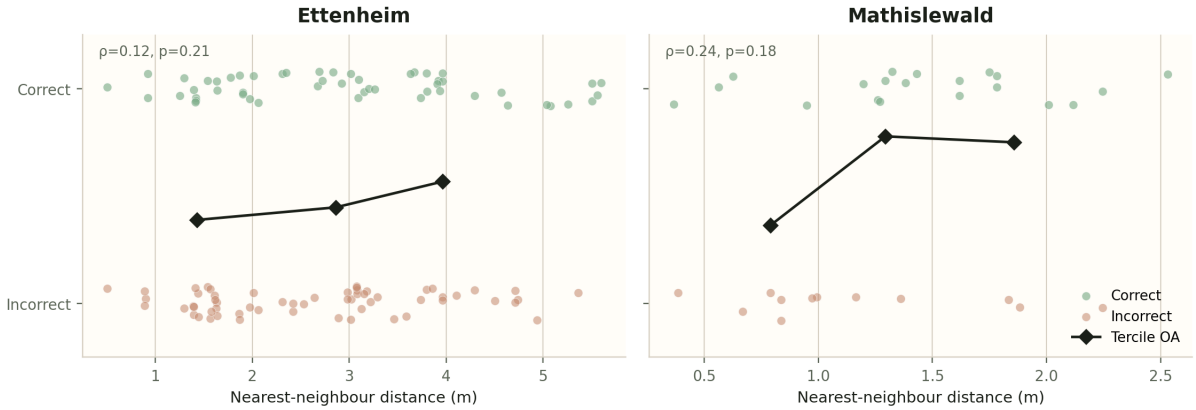


Figure A.8: Manual-track DetailView correctness versus nearest-neighbour distance between whole-tree centroids.

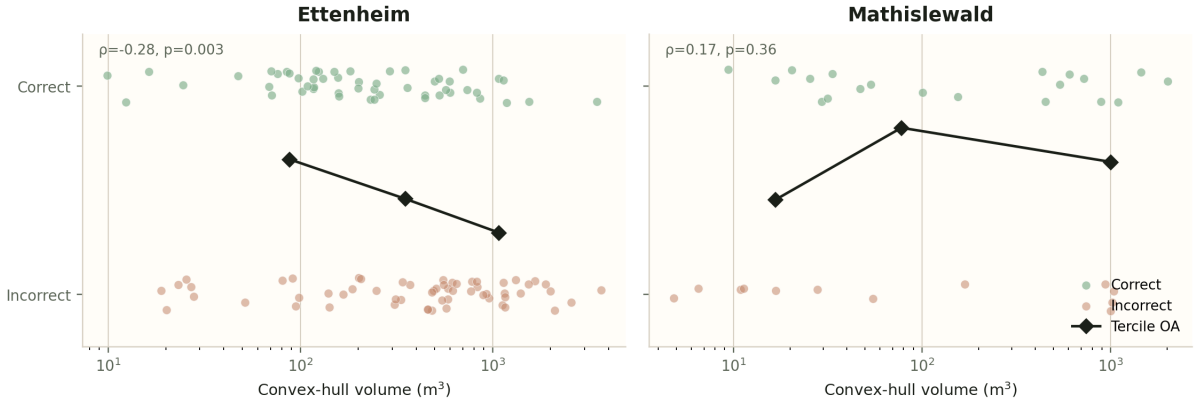


Figure A.9: Manual-track DetailView correctness versus whole-tree convex-hull volume (log x).

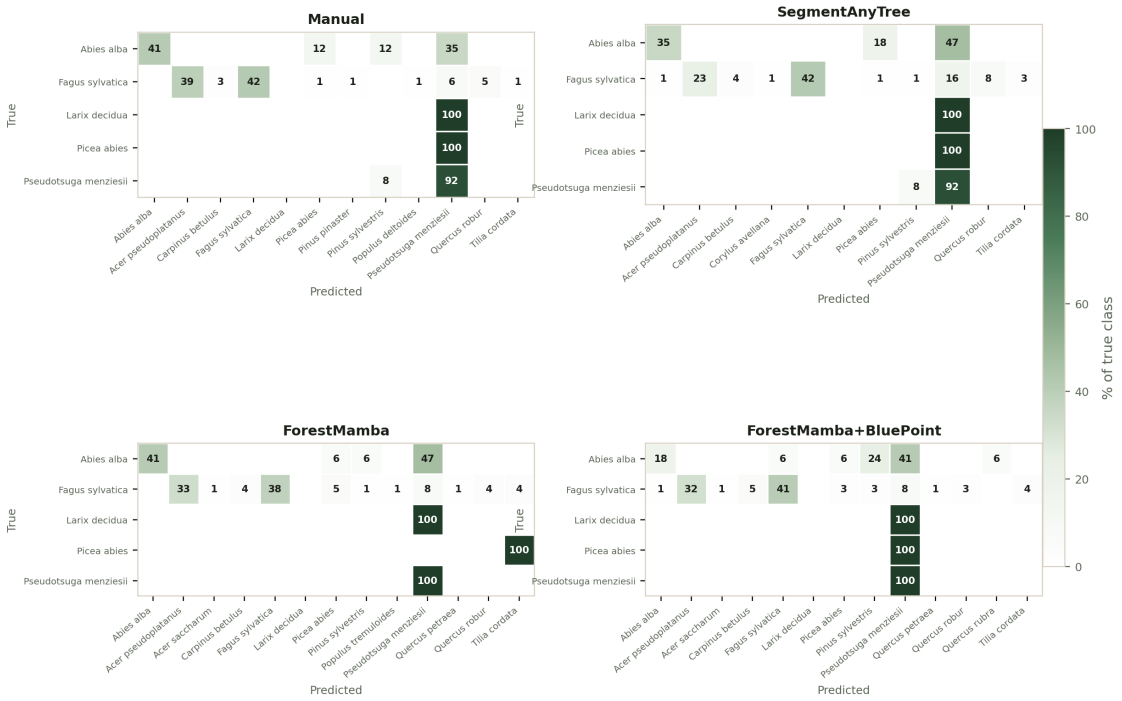


Figure A.10: Ettenheim row-normalized DetailView confusion matrices on the same inventory-matched stems under manual, SegmentAnyTree, ForestMamba and ForestMamba+BluePoint instances ($N = 111$).

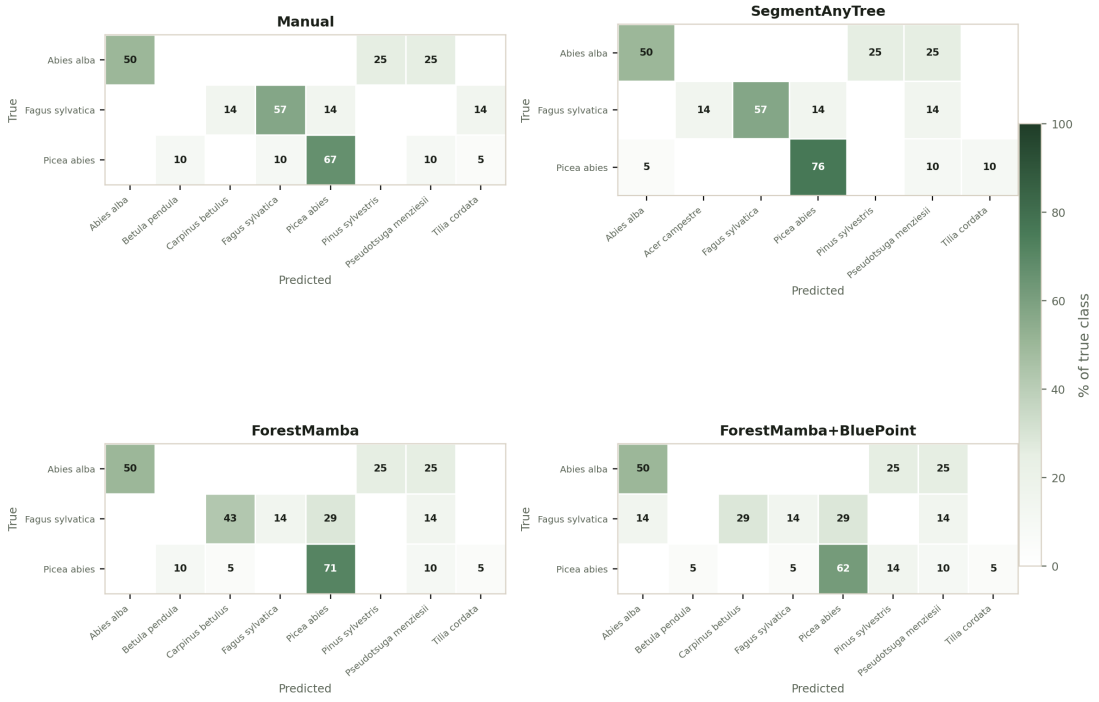


Figure A.11: Mathislewald row-normalized DetailView confusion matrices on the same inventory-matched stems under manual, SegmentAnyTree, ForestMamba and ForestMamba+BluePoint instances ($N = 32$).